Aquifer Open Study Notes

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This resource has been adapted into multiple languages, including English, Tok Pisin, Arabic (عربي), French (Français), Hindi (हिंदी), Indonesian (Bahasa Indonesia), Portuguese (Português), Russian (Русский), Spanish (Español), Swahili (Kiswahili), and Simplified Chinese (简体中文).

Luke

Luke 1:1

- Many people had already begun to write accounts of Jesus's life. Luke was not the first to write this history. Most scholars think Luke used the Gospel of Mark and other written and spoken sources.
- fulfilled: This word can mean "finished" or "completed," but Luke is referring to Jesus making Old Testament promises come true (4:21; 24:44).

Luke 1:1–4

Luke begins his Gospel with a formal introduction written in the style of skilled Greek writers of his time. These first four verses use a careful and formal style. They are among the best-written Greek in the New Testament.

Luke 1:3

- As a good historian, Luke carefully investigated the history of Jesus from the start to provide a reliable story.
- an orderly account: Some versions translate this phrase as "in consecutive order." But it means an organized or carefully written account, not a sequence of time.
- The name Theophilus means "loved by God" or "one who loves God." It is likely a personal name, not meant to describe a name.

Different theories suggest he might be:

1. an unbeliever who was influential in society,
2. a person newly converted to Christianity needing guidance,
3. the judge at the apostle Paul's trial (the book of Acts ends with Paul in prison in Rome, waiting for his trial, or
4. the person who funded Luke's writing project.

The fourth option is the most likely because it was common when writing literature to honor the person who funded it. The Greek word translated as most excellent indicates someone of important social status.

Luke 1:5

- Herod king of Judea: See the profile on "Herod the Great."
- a priest named Zechariah: He was a descendant of Aaron, the brother of Moses (Exodus 28:1).
- who belonged to the priestly division of Abijah: See the study note on Luke 1:8–9 and also 1 Chronicles 24:10.
- Elizabeth was a descendant of Aaron: Jews considered it especially spiritual for a priest to marry a woman from a priestly family.

Luke 1:5–2.52

The Gospel of Luke's first two chapters describe the birth of Jesus and introduce key themes that appear later in Luke and Acts. The announcements and birth stories of Jesus and John the Baptist appear together, emphasizing their roles in bringing God's salvation.

At each point, Luke's Gospel shows Jesus to be greater. John is the forerunner announcing the coming of Jesus, while Jesus is the Savior.

Luke 1:7

Elizabeth was barren: Giving birth to children was a woman's greatest role in this culture. Being unable to have children made women feel ashamed. God miraculously intervened in the lives of various Old Testament women so they could have children (Genesis 18:10–12; 25:21; 30:22–23; Judges 13; 1 Samuel 1:1–28).

Luke 1:8–9

- Zechariah's division was on duty ... he was chosen by lot: It was common in Old Testament times to cast lots (similar to throwing dice) to determine God's will (1 Chronicles 26:13–16; Nehemiah 11:1; Proverbs 16:33; Jonah 1:7). There were 24 orders of priests that took turns serving in the temple (1 Chronicles 24:1–19). They cast lots to choose which priest would serve in the sanctuary of the temple. There were many priests, so this honor might come only once in a priest's life. The angel appeared at the most holy moment of Zechariah's life.
- to enter the temple of the Lord and burn incense: Luke uses the Greek word naos to refer to the temple building. He did mean the whole temple complex (hieron), which he refers to as "the temple courts" (Luke 2:27). The temple complex included the Holy Place and the Most Holy Place (see Hebrews 9:1–5). The priests burned incense twice a day in the Holy Place.

Luke 1:12–13

- he was startled and gripped with fear: Fear and awe are common reactions when someone sees an angel or experiences the presence of God (Judges 6:22–23; 13:22; Isaiah 6:5). The person is often reassured by a saying such as "Do not be afraid."
- you are to give him the name John: In Hebrew, the name John means "the Lord has shown favor." This favor came to Elizabeth and Zechariah through their

son and to the Israelite nation through the Christ (Messiah), whose coming John would announce.

Luke 1:15

- He shall never take wine or strong drink: In the Old Testament, avoiding alcohol was part of the Nazirite vow (a special commitment to God; see Numbers 6:1–21). This commitment or promise to God was usually temporary (see Acts 18:18; 21:23, 26).

It was a commitment for life for some people, such as:

- Samson (Judges 13:4–7),
- Samuel (compare 1 Samuel 1:11), and
- John the Baptist.
- filled with the Holy Spirit even from his mother's womb: See Luke 1:41, 44.

Luke 1:17

he will go on before the Lord in the spirit and power of Elijah: The prophet Malachi prophesied that God would send Elijah before the time of God's salvation (see Malachi 3:1; 4:5–6). John the Baptist filled this role by preparing the way for the Lord's coming.

Luke 1:19

I am Gabriel: The Bible names two angels:

- Gabriel (Daniel 8:16; 9:21)
- Michael (Daniel 10:13; 12:1; Jude 1:9; Revelation 12:7)

Luke 1:20

- now you will be silent and unable to speak: God's discipline for Zechariah's lack of faith also confirmed the prophecy. The Greek word translated as "unable to speak" in 1:22 can also mean "deaf" (7:22; compare 1:62).
- Zechariah is contrasted with Mary, the mother of Jesus, who responded with faith (1:38).

Luke 1:24

for five months remained in seclusion: Why she did this is uncertain and does not seem related to any Old Testament custom or command. Perhaps it was an act of spiritual commitment to honor God for answered prayer.

Luke 1:26

Nazareth was a small village in Galilee, southwest of the Sea of Galilee. People did not think highly of it (see John 1:46).

Luke 1:27

- pledged in marriage: In Jewish culture, families arranged marriages, and pledging someone in marriage was a formal legal contract. Girls were usually married by their mid-teens.
- Joseph, who was of the house of David: See Matthew 1:1–16. Joseph's ancestry is important because the Christ (Messiah) was to be a descendant of King David (2 Samuel 7:11–16; Isaiah 9:7).

Luke 1:31

you are to give Him the name Jesus: The name Jesus means "the Lord saves."

Luke 1:32–33

These verses echo God's covenant with David (a binding promise God made with King David; 2 Samuel 7:11–16). This promise became the foundation for the hope of a coming Messiah (the Christ, God's chosen king and savior; see also Isaiah 9:6–7; 11:1–5; Jeremiah 23:5–6; 33:15–16; Ezekiel 37:24–25).

Luke 1:35

The Holy Spirit will come upon you: The conception of Jesus (how he began to grow in Mary's womb) was a miracle, by the power of the Most High (a title for God). The text does not explain how this happened.

Luke 1:36

Elizabeth your relative: The King James Version calls Elizabeth Mary's cousin, but the Greek word is less specific. It refers more generally to a female relative, so the exact family relationship is not known.

Luke 1:39

The hill country of Judah was (129 to 161 kilometers (80 to 100 miles) from Nazareth. This journey would take at least four days to travel on foot.

Luke 1:41

- The baby leaped in her womb (see 1:15): John was already announcing the Messiah's coming.
- Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit: In the Old Testament, being filled with the Spirit was often associated with a prophetic gift. The Spirit of prophecy was again appearing in Israel (see 1:67; 2:25, 27).

Luke 1:46–55

Mary's song is the first of three songs of praise in the birth story of Jesus. It is called the Magnificat (Latin

for "magnifies"). The song has many similarities to Hannah's prayer in 1 Samuel 2:1–10.

The fact that God cares for the oppressed and reverses their fortunes is a common theme throughout Luke's Gospel. The coming of God's kingdom brings salvation to rejected and outcast people.

Luke 1:48

all generations will call me blessed: In Middle Eastern culture, honor and shame were very important. People also deeply valued the family name they would leave to future generations.

Luke 1:51

His arm represents God's great power (see Psalm 98:1; Isaiah 40:10).

Luke 1:54–55

- Gabriel's words in 1:32–33 refer back to God's promise to King David. Here, Mary refers to God's promise to Abraham (Genesis 12:1–3; 17:3–8).
- The arrival of Jesus brought glory to Israel and salvation to Gentiles (see Luke 2:32).

Luke 1:59

- God commanded every Israelite to circumcise their boys when eight days old (Genesis 17:9–14; Leviticus 12:3). Circumcision marked the child's entry into Israel's covenant community.
- they were going to name him after his father Zechariah: Naming a child after a relative was common. The family and friends were surprised because John was not the name of any of his relatives.

Luke 1:62–63

they made signs: This was because Zechariah was not able to speak or hear (see study note on 1:20). Zechariah showed his faith and obedience to God by naming the child John. As a result, God restored his voice and hearing.

Luke 1:66

the Lord's hand: This anthropomorphism (describing God with human characteristics, compare 1:51) meant that God was at work in John's life.

Luke 1:67–79

This second song of praise in the birth story of Jesus is called the Benedictus (Latin for "Blessed" or "Praise"). The song expects that God's Messiah (his chosen leader) will save the Israelites from their enemies. Salvation includes physical rescue and forgiveness of sins (1:77).

Luke 1:68

He has visited and redeemed His people: This recalls the exodus from Egypt, when God rescued his people from Pharaoh (Exodus 3:7–10, 17–20).

Luke 1:69

- He has raised up a horn of salvation: A horn of salvation refers to the horn of a strong animal like a ram or an ox. To raise up a horn means to show strength and power (see also Psalms 89:24; 132:17).
- in the house of His servant David: See study note on Luke 1:32–33.

Luke 1:71

salvation from our enemies: This refers to what many people in Israel hoped for. They expected God to rescue them from their physical enemies, especially the Romans. But Jesus came to bring a deeper salvation. He saves people from sin, from Satan, and from death.

Luke 1:76–77

- And you, child: Zechariah turned from speaking about the coming Messiah to address his newborn son, John, who would prepare the Messiah's way.
- called a prophet of the Most High: JJohn was the last and greatest in the line of Old Testament prophets (see 7:28).
- prepare the way for Him: See Isaiah 40:3.

Luke 1:78

the Dawn will visit us from on high: The Old Testament identifies the Messiah (Christ) as a light shining in darkness (Isaiah 9:2; 42:6–7; 49:6; Malachi 4:2).

Luke 1:80

- the child grew and became strong in spirit: Compare 2:40, 52; 1 Samuel 2:21, 26; 3:19.
- John likely lived in the wilderness west of the Jordan River and southeast of Jerusalem. This area was a place of spiritual testing (Deuteronomy 8:2; Psalms 78, 95, 107). It was also a place for spiritual retreat and preparation (Exodus 3; 1 Kings 19:4–6, 11–18; Isaiah 40:3).

Luke 2:1

- Caesar Augustus was also called Octavian. He ruled the Roman Empire from 27 BC to AD 14. Before his rule, Rome was a republic governed by the Senate. The Senate gave Augustus supreme power,

and Rome became an empire. Augustus protected the empire's borders and began the Pax Romana ("Roman Peace"). This was a long period of peace and success around the Mediterranean Sea.
- A census was an official count of the people. Rome used a census to register people for taxes.

Luke 2:1–7

After describing the birth of John, Luke gives a similar account of the birth of Jesus. Luke emphasizes the lowliness (very humble condition) of the birth of Jesus. Although Jesus was the Messiah (God's chosen king and deliverer), he entered the world in humble circumstances.

Luke 2:2

Quirinius was governor of Syria: He held this position from AD 6 to AD 9. Earlier, from 6 to 4 BC, he also had authority in Judea, perhaps through a form of joint rule. He may have begun the census (an official count of people for taxes).

Historical records mention three other censuses at that time in Syria, Gaul, and Spain. It would not be unusual to have one in Judea, even though no nonbiblical record mentions it.

Jesus was born around 6 to 4 BC, before the death of Herod the Great in 4 BC (see Matthew 2:1–19).

Luke 2:3–4

Since Joseph was a descendant of King David, he returned to David's hometown of Bethlehem (1 Samuel 17:12, 58; 20:6). Bethlehem is a small village in Judea, eight kilometers (five miles) south of Jerusalem. The prophet Micah foretold that the Christ (the Messiah, God's chosen king) would be born there (Micah 5:2).

Luke 2:5

Mary, who was pledged to him in marriage: See study note on 1:27.

Luke 2:7

- wrapped Him in swaddling cloths: This was a common way to show motherly love and care (see Ezekiel 16:4).
- a manger: This was a feeding container for animals.
- there was no room for them in the inn: The word translated as inn does not refer to a commercial inn (a place where travelers pay to stay). Such inns were likely not found in a small town like Bethlehem. It more likely refers to a guest room in a private home or a simple shelter for travelers. Since there was no usual place to stay, Joseph and Mary went to an area where animals were kept.

Luke 2:8

- Shepherds were sometimes described in Judaism as wandering people and even as dishonest troublemakers. However, this view was not the same everywhere. In the Old Testament, shepherds are often seen in a positive way (for example, Psalm 23:1). Jesus came to people like these, who were ordinary, poor, and humble.
- residing in the fields: This detail suggests a warmer time of year, perhaps from March to November, although some shepherds stayed outside all year. We do not know the exact month Jesus was born.
- They guarded their flocks against thieves and wild animals.

Luke 2:9–10

- terrified: Like Zechariah and Mary, the angel's presence was both glorious and frightening. The angel told the shepherds, "Do not be afraid!" (compare 1:11–13, 28–30).
- I bring you good news: This Greek verb (euangelizō, meaning "to bring good news") comes from the same root as the word euangelion ("good news" or "gospel"). In the Berean Standard Bible, euangelion is often translated as "gospel" (for example, Galatians 2:5, 7, 14). Isaiah's prophecies describe God's salvation as "good tidings" or "good news" (see, for example, Isaiah 52:7; 61:1).
- for all the people: In Luke's writings, the people (a singular term in Greek) always refers to the people of Israel. The shepherds were told that Israel's salvation had arrived. It would eventually go to all nations.

Luke 2:11

The word "Messiah" means "Anointed One." It comes from the Hebrew word mashiakh and is translated into Greek as Christos. The Messiah refers to the promised savior who would come from King David's family line (see study note on 1:32–33). As the apostles started preaching the good news about Jesus to the non-Jewish world, Christians started using Christos more as a name than a title.

Luke 2:12

a sign: Shepherds would notice the contrast between the baby's security and his lowly circumstances. He was wrapped in strips of cloth, but he was lying in a manger, an animal feeding box. This was unusual and showed that God was at work.

Luke 2:13

the heavenly host: These armies from heaven show God's ultimate power and authority (2 Kings 6:17; Psalm 148:2). LORD of Hosts is a common Old Testament name for God (for example, 1 Samuel 1:11; 17:45; 2 Samuel 7:8; Isaiah 5:16; Romans 9:29; James 5:4).

Luke 2:14

- Glory to God in the highest: This short hymn is known as the Gloria in excelsis Deo from the Latin translation of the first line. The Messiah's coming brings glory to God in the heavens and peace to humans on earth.
- peace to men on whom His favor rests: Peace means "complete well-being," not just the absence of hostility. The traditional translation, "on earth peace, good will toward men" in the King James Version, is based on the reading of some late manuscripts. The Berean Standard Bible text follows other early versions. Peace comes to those who receive God's grace.

Luke 2:19

Mary treasured up all these things and pondered them in her heart: Mary kept these things in her heart. This may mean she thought deeply about what had happened and wondered what the future of Jesus would be. It may also mean that Luke learned about these events from Mary herself.

Luke 2:20

glorifying and praising God: These are major themes throughout Luke's Gospel (for example, 1:64; 2:13, 28; 5:25–26; 7:16; 13:13; 17:15, 18; 18:43; 19:37; 23:47; 24:53).

Luke 2:21

eight days before His circumcision had passed: See study note on 1:59.

Luke 2:22

- the time of purification: The law of Moses required women to complete a 40-day ceremony of purification after giving birth (Leviticus 12). After this period, they would offer the sacrifice commanded by the law (Luke 2:24).
- to present Him to the Lord: Every person or thing born first belonged to the Lord, so the Israelites would present (or consecrate) them to God. Humans were bought back with a redemption price (see Exodus 13:1–2, 15; 34:19–20; Numbers 3:11–13; 18:15–16; Nehemiah 10:35–36).

Luke 2:24

A pair of turtledoves or two young pigeons: This quote from Leviticus 12:8 refers to the ceremony to make a woman ceremonially pure after giving birth to a child. Joseph and Mary offered the sacrifice prescribed for the poor.

Luke 2:25

- Simeon ... was righteous and devout: This is like Zechariah and Elizabeth (1:6). They represent the faithful people of Israel who were waiting for God's salvation (Isaiah 10:20–22). Some think Simeon was a priest, but the text only says he was a devout man in Jerusalem.
- He was waiting for the consolation of Israel: This refers to Isaiah 40:1, which promised "comfort" to Israel after returning from exile in Babylon.
- the Holy Spirit was upon him: See study note on Luke 1:41.

Luke 2:26

the Lord's Christ (or the Lord's Anointed): This title was first used for kings like David. It later came to refer to the Christ or Messiah (God's chosen king and deliverer), who would come from David's family line.

Luke 2:27

into the temple courts: This refers to the temple complex, not the sanctuary. See study note on 1:8–9.

Luke 2:29–32

This third great hymn of the birth narrative is called the Nunc dimittis ("now dismiss"), from the first words of the Latin translation. The hymn praises God for allowing Simeon to see God's salvation.

Luke 2:30

my eyes have seen Your salvation: This phrase echoes Isaiah 52:12. The wording is similar and recalls the language of that passage.

Luke 2:31

The plural form of people means all peoples (see study note on 2:9–10). It includes both Jews and Gentiles. Gentiles are people who are not part of the Jewish people.

Luke 2:32

- The prophet Isaiah predicted that the kingdom of God would bring salvation to all the nations (Isaiah 42:6–7; 49:6).

- the glory of your people Israel: This quote from Isaiah 46:13 says that God's salvation will bring glory to Israel. Israel's role in the Old Testament was to bring glory to God by revealing God's light to the nations.

Luke 2:34

- to cause the rise and fall of many in Israel: Many Israelites did not accept Jesus as the Christ (see Isaiah 8:14–15).
- a sign: See Luke 11:29–30; compare Isaiah 8:18.

Luke 2:35

- The thoughts of many hearts: Israel's true inner response to God would be made known through how they respond to Jesus.
- a sword will pierce your soul as well: Mary would experience great pain watching her son suffer and die on the cross.

Luke 2:36–38

- Anna is the Greek version of the Hebrew name Hannah, Samuel's mother (1 Samuel 1–2). Jewish tradition recognizes seven Old Testament women as prophets:
- Sarah,
- Miriam,
- Deborah,
- Hannah,
- Abigail,
- Huldah, and
- Esther.

In this story, Anna was also a prophetic witness to the identity of Jesus as the Christ.

- the tribe of Asher: This was one of the 10 northern tribes of Israel. Asher was the eighth son of the patriarch Jacob (Genesis 30:12–13). Most of the Israelites who returned from exile in Babylon were from the tribe of Judah. Other Israelites also knew the family line of their tribe during the time of Jesus. For example, the apostle Paul was "of the tribe of Benjamin" (Philippians 3:5).

Luke 2:37

- was a widow to the age of eighty-four: In the ancient world, people associated old age with wisdom and honor.
- She never left the temple: This is likely an intentional extreme statement (an exaggeration). It is the same as saying something like, "She was there all the time." This statement shows her total commitment to God.

Luke 2:40

He was filled with wisdom, and the grace of God was upon Him (compare 1:80; 2:52): The two statements about the wisdom of Jesus (2:40, 52) emphasize the story of his unusual wisdom at a young age.

Luke 2:41

The Jewish Passover feast celebrates God's deliverance of Israel from slavery in Egypt. It was one of three major annual feasts required for Jewish men to attend (Exodus 23:14–17; Deuteronomy 16:16). The family of Jesus faithfully followed God's law and practiced their faith.

Luke 2:41–51

Jesus visiting Jerusalem at age 12 is the only story from his childhood in the gospels. The main theme is his early spiritual insight. This includes how he is increasingly aware of his special relationship with God and his unique mission.

Luke 2:42

He was twelve years old: A Jewish boy took on his covenant responsibilities (duties in God's agreement with his people) at about age 13. The bar mitzvah (a later ceremony marking this stage) developed afterward to express this custom.

By bringing Jesus to Jerusalem at this time, his parents were preparing him to take his place in the covenant community.

Luke 2:44

Assuming He was in their company: Joseph and Mary were probably traveling with a large caravan of relatives and friends from Galilee. Jesus probably spent a lot of time with his friends and relatives, so his parents were not worried at first.

Luke 2:46

The three days likely included one day traveling from Jerusalem, one day traveling back, and one day searching.

• in the temple courts: He was in the temple complex, not the sanctuary.

• listening to them and asking them questions: Jesus was acting like a student. In rabbinic teaching (the teaching methods of Jewish teachers), a teacher often answered a student's question by asking more questions. Jesus asked wise questions and gave wise answers, and this amazed the teachers.

Luke 2:47

astounded at His understanding and His answers: Jesus fulfilled Isaiah 11:2.

Luke 2:49

Did you not know that I had to be in My Father's house?: Jesus knew his most important relationship was with his Father in heaven.

Luke 2:51

Although Jesus recognized his relationship to his heavenly Father, he was obedient to his earthly parents.

Luke 3:1

- In the fifteenth year of the reign of Tiberius Caesar: Tiberius Caesar began to rule with his stepfather, Caesar Augustus, in AD 11. He became the sole emperor in AD 14 and ruled until AD 37. Luke may be counting from either AD 11 or AD 14. If so, John began his public ministry around AD 26/27 or AD 29/30. Jesus began his own ministry soon after John.
- Pontius Pilate was governor of Judea from AD 26 to 36 (see "Pontius Pilate" Profile).
- Herod tetrarch of Galilee: See "Herod Antipas" Profile.
- Antipas's half-brother Philip was another son of Herod the Great. Philip ruled as tetrarch of the region northeast of Galilee from 4 BC until his death in AD 34. Tetrarch means "the ruler of a fourth of a kingdom." The term later meant any minor ruler. Philip was a half brother of both Antipas and Herod Philip (Matthew 14:3; Mark 6:17).

Luke 3:1–4.13

After the birth story, Luke prepares his audience for the public ministry of Jesus. He describes the work of John the Baptist, who comes before the Messiah (the Christ, God's chosen king). He also tells about the baptism, family line (genealogy), and temptation of Jesus.

Luke 3:2

- Annas and Caiaphas were Jewish high priests. Annas served from AD 6 to 15 until the Romans removed him. His son-in-law, Caiaphas, was the high priest from AD 18 to 36. Luke mentions both names because Annas was still very influential among the Jews (see John 18:13–14, 24; Acts 4:6).
- the word of God came to John son of Zechariah: John's role as a prophet was similar to that of the Old Testament prophets (see, for example, Isaiah 6; Jeremiah 1).

Luke 3:3

preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins: John seems to have adapted the practice of baptism from Jewish rites using water to cleanse, or set apart, people and objects for God's service (compare Leviticus 8:6). John called people to repent of their sins and prepare spiritually for the Messiah's coming. Their baptism publicly demonstrated their repentance and spiritual cleansing.

Luke 3:4–6

- The quotation is from the ancient Greek version of Isaiah 40:3–5. It describes God bringing the Jews back from exile in Babylon. After they returned (Ezra 1–2). John shouted in the wilderness to prepare God's people for the Lord's coming. God's salvation is portrayed as a new exodus, bringing deliverance like the first exodus from Egypt.
- make straight paths for Him ... the rough ways smooth: This image reflects the Middle Eastern custom of preparing a road for a king (compare Luke 19:36–38).

Luke 3:7

God's coming wrath is the judgment for all who reject the gospel. Israel as a nation would experience this wrath in the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70 (see 21:20–23).

Luke 3:8

- We have Abraham as our father: Some Jews believed that being part of Abraham's family line guaranteed their salvation (see John 8:33–39; Acts 7:2; Romans 4:1).
- And do not begin to say to yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father.': God chose the Israelites as his people, but he could reject them. If he wanted, he could create children of Abraham from these very stones (compare Hosea 1:3–9; Romans 9:6–8, 27–28; 11:17–21).

Luke 3:9

every tree that does not produce good fruit: If Israel did not repent and produce good works, God would judge them to be as worthless as a vineyard without grapes (see Isaiah 5:1–7; compare Luke 13:7–9; 20:9–19).

Luke 3:11

two tunics: The Greek word refers to a long shirt worn next to the skin. Even the smallest surplus should be shared with others in need.

Luke 3:12

even tax collectors: In the first century, many people strongly disliked tax collectors. They were known for taking extra money and were seen as working for the Roman rulers, who were widely hated.

Luke 3:14

These soldiers were probably not Roman, but local Jewish troops under the authority of Herod Antipas. They might have been assigned to protect the tax collectors. John does not condemn either tax collectors or soldiers but calls them to honesty and integrity.

Luke 3:16

- the straps of whose sandals I am not worthy to untie: The untying of sandals was done only by slaves. John was showing great honor to Jesus the Messiah.
- Baptize you with the Holy Spirit and fire: Old Testament prophets said God would give his Spirit to his people in the last times (Isaiah 32:15, Ezekiel 36:28–29; Joel 2:28). This prophecy partly came true on the day of Pentecost (Acts 2). Fire often represents judgment (see Luke 3:9). It can also represent the spiritual cleansing and purifying of God's people (see 1 Corinthians 3:10–15; compare Isaiah 4:4; Malachi 3:2).

Luke 3:17

- After being harvested, the kernels of wheat would be beaten off the stalks and then tossed in the air with a winnowing fork to separate them from the chaff. The heavy grain would fall to the ground as the lighter chaff blew away. This is an image of separation for judgment.
- unquenchable fire: See Isaiah 66:24.

Luke 3:19–20

Herod Antipas was the ruler of Galilee. He divorced his first wife and married Herodias. Herodias was the wife of his half-brother Herod Philip.

When John publicly criticized Herod for this sin, Herod imprisoned and later executed him (compare 9:9; Mark 6:16–29). Herod's execution of John is also recorded by the Jewish historian Josephus (Antiquities 18.5.2).

Luke 3:21

- And as He was praying: Luke shows that Jesus trusted God and depended on him through prayer (5:16; 6:12; 9:18, 28; 11:1; 22:32, 41, 44; 23:34, 46).
- heaven was opened: This image was a sign of
- God's presence (Isaiah 64:1),
- divine revelation (Ezekiel 1:1; John 1:51), and
- the end of an age (a major period in God's plan; Revelation 4:1; 15:5; 19:11).

Luke 3:21–22

The baptism of Jesus marked the beginning of his public ministry and his anointing as the Christ (the Messiah, the one chosen and set apart by God). God spoke from heaven and confirmed who Jesus is and the mission he came to do.

Luke 3:22

- The Holy Spirit might have looked like a dove, or it might have come down as a dove would.
- You are My beloved Son; in You I am well pleased: This statement connects with Psalm 2:7 and Isaiah 42:1.
- Psalm 2:7 shows that Jesus is the Messiah (the Christ, the promised King) from David's family line.
- Isaiah 42:1 shows the servant of the Lord (the one chosen to carry out God's work).

God again declared who Jesus is from heaven at his transfiguration (when his appearance was changed in glory; Luke 9:35).

Luke 3:23

- Jesus Himself was about thirty years old: This is the only place in the New Testament that mentions how old Jesus was during his public ministry. The number is not exact. Jesus was born between 6 and 4 BC (see study note on 2:2). He began his ministry between AD 27 and 29 (see study note on 3:1). This means he was probably about 31 to 35 years old when he began his public ministry.
- He was regarded as the son of Joseph: People understood Jesus to be Joseph's son. He was Joseph's legal son, but not his biological son.
- the son of Heli: If this passage gives Mary's genealogy (a family line), as some think (see study note on 3:23–38), then Joseph may have been Heli's son-in-law rather than his biological son. This is one possible meaning of the Greek sentence.

Luke 3:23–38

This record of the family line of Jesus is in the opposite order from Matthew's list (Matthew 1:1–17). Luke traces

the family line of Jesus back to Adam. This may show that Jesus is connected to all people as the Son of God (Luke 3:38).

Matthew's list moves from Abraham down to Joseph. It shows that Jesus is the rightful heir (legal ruler) of David's throne and the one who receives God's promises to Abraham.

The two lists are very different. Because of this, some people suggest that Luke's list is actually Mary's family line (see study note on 3:23). If so, Mary may have been one of Luke's main sources when he wrote his Gospel.

Luke 3:27

Zerubbabel was the governor of Judea. The Persians chose him when the Jews returned from exile in Babylon. He supervised the effort to build the temple again (Ezra 3:2, 8).

Luke 3:31

Nathan was King David's third son, born in Jerusalem (2 Samuel 5:14). This is not the same person as Nathan the prophet (2 Samuel 7:2).

Luke 3:32

Boaz married Ruth, who was from Moab (see Ruth 2–4).

Luke 3:38

- Seth was the third son of Adam and Eve. He was born after Cain killed Abel and God sent Cain away (Genesis 4:25–26).
- Adam was the son of God because he had no earthly father. God created him. When Satan tempted Jesus in the wilderness, Satan repeatedly says to Jesus, "If you are the Son of God..." Adam was the first son of God and failed when tested. But Jesus, the Son of God in the fullest sense, successfully resisted temptation.

Luke 4:1–13

The devil tried to tempt Jesus to ignore his Father's plan of salvation by seeking power and glory for himself. The temptation in the wilderness for 40 days is similar to Israel's 40 years of testing there. Israel failed the test, but Jesus succeeded.

Luke 4:2

tempted by the devil: The term diabolos ("devil") is a Greek translation of the Hebrew satan, meaning "accuser" or "adversary" (1 Chronicles 21:1; Job 1:1–2:13; Zechariah 3:1–2). Luke uses both terms ("devil," Luke 4:3, 6, 13; 8:12; "Satan," 10:18; 11:18; 13:16; 22:3, 31).

Satan tempted Adam and Eve and failed. Jesus is called the second Adam because he is a new beginning for humanity. He resisted temptation, unlike Adam and Eve. Because of this, he reversed the judgment against Adam and Eve.

Luke 4:3

If You are the Son of God: Both Israel and Adam are called God's son (3:38; Exodus 4:22–23; Hosea 11:1). Jesus, the Son of God in the fullest sense, succeeded where Adam and Israel failed.

Luke 4:4

Man shall not live on bread alone: Israel complained constantly about hunger in the wilderness, but Jesus depended on God's strength to sustain him.

Luke 4:6

I can give it to anyone I wish: The New Testament elsewhere describes Satan's limited rule over the present world order (John 12:31; 14:30; 16:11; Ephesians 2:2; 1 John 5:19).

Luke 4:8

Worship the Lord your God and serve Him only: When Israel encountered difficulties in the wilderness, they started to worship false gods (Deuteronomy 9:12). Jesus refused to worship Satan.

Luke 4:10–11

After being driven back twice by Scripture, the devil quoted Scripture to Jesus. He cited a passage that speaks of God's protection for his people.

Luke 4:12

Do not put the Lord your God to the test: In the wilderness, Israel constantly tested God's faithfulness, but Jesus responded with complete trust in God.

Luke 4:13

The next opportune time could have been when Judas betrayed Jesus (22:3–6, 21–22, 47–48). The greatest test occurred in the garden of Gethsemane (22:39–46).

Luke 4:14

- Jesus returned to Galilee: The story of the ministry of Jesus in Galilee begins here, and continues through 9:50.

- in the power of the Spirit: At his baptism, Jesus was anointed and empowered to accomplish his role as the Messiah (see 3:22; 4:1, 14, 18).

Luke 4:16–30

The sermon Jesus gave in Nazareth showed what his whole public ministry would be about. He returned to the synagogue in his hometown to announce the good news that God's salvation had come. The people were pleased at first. But then Jesus reminded them that God also reaches out to Gentiles, not only to Jews. This made the crowd so angry that they tried to kill him.

Luke 4:18–19

the year of the Lord's favor: This refers to the Year of Jubilee (Leviticus 25:8–55). During this time, people forgave debts, freed slaves, and returned land to its original owners. In Isaiah 61, the Year of Jubilee is a metaphor for God's salvation.

Luke 4:21

- is fulfilled: Jesus announced that his presence marked the new age of salvation (God's saving work among his people).
- Today: Compare 2:11; 5:26; 19:9; 23:43.

Luke 4:23

- Physician, heal yourself!: This was a common saying in ancient times. It could mean something like, "show your ability to heal" or "help your own people, not just others."
- that You did in Capernaum: See 4:31–44.

Luke 4:25–26

widow of Zarephath: See 1 Kings 17–18.

Luke 4:27

Naaman the Syrian: See 2 Kings 5.

Luke 4:28

The people in the synagogue were angry because Jesus mentioned that God had shown favor to Gentiles (non-Jewish people). Many Jews believed that only they received God's favor. They were also living under Roman rule, and Gentiles ruled over them. So Jesus's words felt very offensive to them.

Luke 4:30

Jesus passed through the crowd: The main emphasis is on the royal status and authority of Jesus. His time had not yet come. His time had not yet come (compare John 7:30, 44; 8:20, 59). This attempt to kill Jesus pointed ahead to his crucifixion. His escape also points ahead to his resurrection.

Luke 4:31

Jesus left Nazareth and made Capernaum his main base during his work in Galilee (see Mark 2:1).

Luke 4:33

the spirit of an unclean demon: Here unclean means "defiled" or "wicked."

Luke 4:34

- Have you come to destroy us?: Although there was only one demon present, the use of us suggests that all of Satan's forces knew about and were fearful of the coming of Jesus.
- I know who You are: In ancient times, people believed that naming a spiritual power gave them control over it. The demon might have been trying to gain power over Jesus.

Luke 4:36

With authority and power He commands: Magicians and exorcists often used long rituals and special spoken formulas (incantations). The people were amazed that Jesus simply spoke a word with his own authority and drove out the demon.

Luke 4:38

- the home of Simon: Simon was from Bethsaida (John 1:44), but he currently lived and worked as a fisherman in Capernaum.
- whose mother-in-law: Peter was married (see 1 Corinthians 9:5). The text does not mention his wife's name.

Luke 4:39

rebuked the fever: Luke uses the same Greek word when Jesus "rebuked the demon" (4:35). Jesus has full authority over both physical and spiritual powers.

Luke 4:41

- You are the Son of God!: This was a title used for the Christ (God's chosen king and deliverer, the Messiah; see 2 Samuel 7:14; Psalms 2:7; 89:26–27). Luke often connects the titles Christ and the Son of God (Luke 9:35; 22:66–71; Acts 9:20, 22).
- would not allow them to speak: Jesus often showed his authority over demons by making them silent. He wanted to reveal his identity in his own way, not through their announcement.

Luke 4:43

- preach the good news: The Greek verb here is related to the noun often translated as "gospel" or "good news" (see study note on 2:9–10; see also 1:19; 7:22; Matthew 4:23; 24:14; Mark 1:1, 15; 16:15; Acts 8:4, 12; Romans 1:1–6, 15–17; 10:15–17; Galatians 1:6–9; Ephesians 2:14–18; 3:6–7).
- The kingdom of God was the main message of Jesus (see Mark 1:15). God began to show his rule (his kingly authority) through what Jesus said and did.

Luke 4:44

Luke likely used the word Judea in a broad sense, meaning "the land of the Jews." At that time, Jesus was ministering in Galilee in the north (see 5:1), not in Judea in the south.

Luke 5:1–11

This is the first time Luke records Jesus calling the disciples to follow him. Matthew and Mark describe an earlier calling of the four brothers who were fishermen (Matthew 4:18–22; Mark 1:16–20). Jesus showed great authority in the miraculous catch of fish and in his call of Simon Peter.

Luke 5:3

And sitting down, He taught the people from the boat: By sitting a little away from the shore, Jesus had a place to speak without the people pressing against him.

Luke 5:4

let down your nets for a catch: Peter was naturally unsure when a teacher told fishermen how to catch fish. It seemed strange for three reasons:

1. When the sun rose, the fish went down to the bottom of the lake. This is why they usually fished at night.
2. They used a heavy net that hung from the side of the boat, held by two men (or stretched between two boats), so they could not fish in deep water.
3. They had just fished all night and caught nothing, so it now seemed even less likely they would catch anything.

Luke 5:7

- James and John were in the other boat. Along with their father Zebedee, they were business partners with Peter and Andrew (see 5:10; Mark 1:19–20; Mark 1:16).
- boats so full that they began to sink: This dramatic and amazing event showed the authority of Jesus over the forces of nature.

Luke 5:8

I am a sinful man: Compare Isaiah 6:5.

Luke 5:10

Jesus used fishing as a picture to explain how his followers would gather people into the kingdom of God.

Luke 5:11

they left everything: They gave up their work, security, and family ties, which was remarkable in a culture that placed great importance on loyalty to family and clan.

Luke 5:12

who was covered with leprosy: In ancient times, leprosy did not refer only to the modern disease known as leprosy (Hansen's disease). It included various skin problems. To prevent it from spreading, ancient societies forced lepers to live on the edges of communities. The law of Moses gave instructions for how to identify and isolate leprosy (Leviticus 13–14).

Luke 5:13

- Jesus reached out His hand and touched the man: Most people feared catching the disease through physical contact. But Jesus showed compassion. Neither disease nor evil could contaminate him. Instead, he brought healing and salvation.
- Be clean!: This act had spiritual and physical significance, since leprosy separated Israelites from social contact and religious practice.

Luke 5:14

- Jesus often told those he healed not to tell anyone. He did this to avoid drawing too much public attention. But news about these events spread quickly (see 5:15–16; see also "The Secret of the Messiah" Theme Note).
- go, show yourself to the priest and present the offering: A priest had to declare that those healed of leprosy were clean. Then the priest would offer a sacrifice on their behalf.

Luke 5:17

- Pharisees: The Pharisees were a group of Jewish teachers who carefully followed the law of Moses and their traditions. See "The Pharisees" Profile.

- teachers of the law: These teachers were also called scribes and lawyers. They were experts in explaining the law of Moses. Most teachers of the law were Pharisees, but some were Sadducees. The Sadducees were another Jewish group who had different beliefs, especially about the law and the resurrection (life after death).

Luke 5:17–26

The healing of the paralyzed man began the conflicts between Jesus and the religious leaders that continued through his public ministry until his crucifixion in Jerusalem.

Luke 5:19

through the tiles: Houses in Palestine usually had flat roofs made from wooden beams covered with reeds and mud or clay. This roof may have had tiles. Or Luke may have described it this way for his Greek audience.

Luke 5:22

Knowing what they were thinking: While the Pharisees accused Jesus of blasphemy (showing disrespect toward God), he knew what was in their minds. This is something only God can do.

Luke 5:23–24

Jesus showed his authority to forgive sins by healing the man.

Luke 5:24

Son of Man: See "The Son of Man" Theme Note.

Luke 5:27

- tax collector: See study note on 3:12.
- Levi's tax booth was likely a place to collect money for transporting items.
- Levi was also called Matthew (Matthew 9:9; see "Matthew (Levi)" Profile).

Luke 5:27–32

When Jesus called Levi to become his disciple, this led to a second conflict with the religious leaders. It also introduced the idea that Jesus came to save sinners.

Luke 5:29

a great banquet for Jesus: Levi introduced Jesus to his friends and fellow tax collectors to thank him for making Levi a disciple. It was common in the ancient world to repay honor with honor.

Luke 5:30

Meals showed a person's social standing in the ancient world. Eating with someone meant you accepted them. The Pharisees refused to eat with tax collectors and other sinners or to enter their homes. They believed this would make them unclean. They expected Jesus, as a rabbi (a Jewish teacher), to do the same.

But Jesus broke these social rules. He ate with sinners and allowed sinful people to touch him (5:29; 7:39; 15:1). The religious leaders strongly criticized him for this and mockingly called him "a friend of tax collectors and sinners" (7:34).

Luke 5:31–32

Jesus responded that, like a doctor, his mission was to work with sick people, not the healthy. Jesus was not called to minister to self-righteous people, but to those who recognized their spiritual need for God's grace and healing.

Luke 5:33

- John's disciples: Most Jewish rabbis had students who learned from them and served them (see also Acts 19:1–7).
- frequently fast and pray: Many devout Jews fasted two days a week (Luke 18:12). Fasting was associated with spiritual preparation and repentance (Esther 4:16; 2 Samuel 12:22; Joel 1:14; Jonah 3:5). Fasting is not a way to become righteous (to be made right with God; Isaiah 58:4–5; Jeremiah 14:12). But it is a spiritual pratice that helps a person become closer to God. Fasting is often connected to prayer and spiritual retreat.
- but Yours keep on eating and drinking: The point was that they did not fast regularly.

Luke 5:34–35

Can you make the guests of the bridegroom fast: Just as it would be inappropriate for anyone to fast at a wedding celebration, it was inappropriate for people to fast while the Christ (the Messiah, God's chosen king) was with them. God's final salvation is a great wedding feast that God prepares for his people (Isaiah 25:6–8; Luke 14:15–24).

Luke 5:36–38

a new garment ... new wine: New cloth shrinks when it is washed and can tear old cloth. New wine expands as it ferments and can burst old, brittle wineskins. In both cases, both the old and the new are ruined.

These examples show that the old and the new do not work well together. Jesus did not come to patch up the old covenant, but to bring a new one. The kingdom of God brings a new way of thinking and living.

Luke 5:39

The old is better: The religious leaders were resistant to change.

Luke 6:1

His disciples began to pick the heads of grain: The law allowed this kind of grazing while walking through someone else's field (Deuteronomy 23:24–25).

Luke 6:1–11

The conflicts between Jesus and the religious leaders continued with two disagreements about the Sabbath. The law of Moses required the Jews to rest on the Sabbath (Exodus 20:8–11; Deuteronomy 5:13–14). But the Pharisees had forgotten that the real reason for the Sabbath was to benefit human beings.

Luke 6:2

Why are you doing what is unlawful on the Sabbath?: They did not accuse the disciples of stealing grain, but of working on the Sabbath day. They were breaking rules established by oral tradition.

Luke 6:3

While fleeing from Saul (1 Samuel 21), David and his companions went to Nob, a place where the tabernacle was located. The priest Ahimelech gave them the consecrated Bread of the Presence (special bread set before God) that only priests were allowed to eat (Exodus 25:30; Leviticus 24:9).

Jesus meant that meeting human needs is more important than strictly following the law. There may also be a comparison between David and Jesus, since both were chosen and anointed as kings of Israel.

Luke 6:5

Lord of the Sabbath: The saying is a play on words with a double meaning:

- Son of man often means "human being." So Jesus was affirming that the Sabbath day was made to serve human beings.
- Son of Man was also a title for the Christ (God's chosen king; see Daniel 7:13–14).

Jesus is Lord of the Sabbath because he created it.

Luke 6:6–7

- were watching Him closely: Jesus had a reputation for putting human needs above Sabbath commands. So, the religious leaders hoped to catch Jesus working on the Sabbath day.
- if He would heal on the Sabbath: The Jewish rabbis in the time of Jesus debated whether the law allowed people to offer medical help on the Sabbath. It was usually allowed only in extreme emergencies. The withered hand was clearly not an emergency.

Luke 6:8

Get up and stand among us: Jesus did not avoid controversy. He was willing to confront the Pharisees' hypocrisy directly.

Luke 6:9

to do good or to do evil, to save life or to destroy it?: This question challenged the religious leaders' intentions. They were plotting against Jesus (an evil act) because he was going to heal someone (a good act).

Luke 6:12

He spent the night in prayer to God: See study note on 3:21. Jesus prayed before important events and decisions such as choosing the Twelve, who would carry on his ministry after him.

Luke 6:13

- Disciples were students and followers, while apostles were specially commissioned representatives.
- The number twelve symbolically represents the twelve tribes of Israel. The apostles represented the restored people of God.

Luke 6:14

Simon, whom He named Peter: The name Peter means "rock" or "stone" (see Matthew 16:18).

Luke 6:15

- Matthew, also called Levi, was the tax collector for the Romans (see 5:27; Matthew 9:9; 10:3).
- Simon called the Zealot: This title probably meant that he had joined the Zealot movement, a group of Jews actively seeking to overthrow the Roman government.
- The apostles Jesus chose were very different from each other. These two men would not normally have worked together.

Luke 6:16

- Judas (son of James) was probably also called Thaddaeus (Matthew 10:3; Mark 3:18). He was a different person from Judas Iscariot or Jude the half-brother of Jesus (who wrote the New Testament book of Jude).
- Judas Iscariot: Iscariot probably means "from Kerioth," a village 19 kilometers (12 miles) south of Hebron.

Luke 6:17

all over Judea, Jerusalem, and the seacoast of Tyre and Sidon: Tyre and Sidon were coastal cities on the Mediterranean Sea northwest of Galilee. Jesus was gaining wide popularity.

Luke 6:17–49

The main theme of the great sermon of Jesus is that those who repent and enter the kingdom of God will live in a truly righteous way.

Luke 6:20–21

poor ... you who hunger: Compare Matthew 5:3, 6. This statement likely refers to both physical and spiritual poverty. Poverty and suffering tend to make us more dependent on God. The Old Testament includes many promises that God will feed and comfort his people (Psalms 22:26; 107:36–41; 126:1–6; Isaiah 49:10–13; 51:3; 65:13).

Luke 6:20–23

God blesses those who admit their weaknesses and seek strength from God. The value system of God's kingdom is radically different from the world's value system, in which power and strength represent success.

Luke 6:23

treated the prophets in the same way: See "The Suffering Prophet" Theme Note.

Luke 6:24–26

Promises of blessing for the poor and oppressed are balanced in Luke with predictions of sorrow for the rich and powerful. Those who trust in themselves will be humbled, while those who depend on God will be blessed. The Old Testament prophets often pronounced woes against nations and rulers who oppressed God's people and rejected his authority (for example, Isaiah 3:11; 5:8; Jeremiah 50:27; Zechariah 11:17).

Luke 6:27

Love your enemies: People were commonly taught in the ancient world to love their family and friends and hate their enemies. Jesus announced a radical new ethic of loving even one's enemies and overcoming evil through self-sacrificial love for others, not through violence and hatred (compare Romans 12:14–21).

Luke 6:30

if anyone takes what is yours, do not demand it back: This means we can stop the cycle of hate and violence by responding with good, not evil (Romans 12:17). We win the world through love that expects nothing in return.

Jesus was not promoting injustice, as though believers should let criminals take advantage of the weak. God established governments to punish evildoers (Romans 13:1–5).

Luke 6:31

Do to others as you would have them do to you: This saying is often called the Golden Rule. Versions of the Golden Rule appear in many religious and philosophical traditions. In the teaching of Jesus, however, love for all people (including enemies) is not merely one virtue among others but the foundational ethic that governs all behavior.

Luke 6:34–36

The law of Moses did not allow charging interest on loans to fellow Israelites in order to prevent taking advantage of those who were poor (Exodus 22:25; Leviticus 25:35–37; Deuteronomy 23:20). Jesus also taught his followers to lend without expecting repayment. By doing good even to those who do wrong, Christians act as children of the Most High and imitate our Father in heaven, who is merciful to everyone (compare Romans 5:8).

Luke 6:37–42

Do not judge: Jesus condemned judging others in a way that is not honest by acting better than them. Those who judge others this way will experience that same standard. God wants his people to love others by warning them about the dangers of sin (Galatians 6:1; Hebrews 3:13). To encourage is an act of love. To judge as a hypocrite is an act of pride.

Luke 6:38

pressed down, shaken together: A generous grain merchant would top off the buyer's container, press

it down, shake it to make more room, and then pour until the grain overflowed into the buyer's lap.

Luke 6:41

the beam in your own eye: Jesus did not say that we should ignore the speck in another person's eye. Instead, he said that we must first correct our own faults so that we can see clearly enough to help remove the speck. Jesus condemned hypocritical judgment, but he wanted his followers to lovingly help one another turn away from sin.

Luke 6:45

What people receive and value inside themselves will shape how they live. What they keep within their thoughts and desires will come out in their actions.

Luke 6:49

he one who hears My words and does not act on them: See Ezekiel 33:31–33.

Luke 7:1–10

This episode shows God's message of salvation is for Gentiles as well as Jews.

Luke 7:2

centurion: This type of Roman officer was in charge of a group of about 100 soldiers (a century). A Roman legion had 60 centuries, totaling 6,000 soldiers.

Luke 7:3

Jewish elders were leaders in the Jewish community. Matthew's shorter account says that the centurion approached Jesus himself (Matthew 8:5–13). Luke gives more details and explains that Jewish elders, and later the centurion's friends, spoke to Jesus for him.

Luke 7:5

for he loves our nation and has built our synagogue: Wealthy Gentiles often supported Jewish communities in the Roman Empire. This suggests that the centurion might have been "God-fearing" like Cornelius in Acts 10:2. A God-fearing person was a Gentile who worshiped the God of Israel but had not fully converted to Judaism.

Luke 7:6

I am not worthy to have You come under my roof: The man was probably trying to respect Jewish customs. Faithful Jews would not enter the home of a Gentile, because they believed this would make them ceremonially unclean (see Acts 10:28; 11:12). The centurion might also have been acknowledging the greater status of Jesus.

Luke 7:8

I myself am a man under authority: The Roman army was famous for its organization and discipline. The centurion recognized authority when he saw it in the words and actions of Jesus.

Luke 7:9

I tell you, not even in Israel have I found such great faith: While many in Israel were unresponsive to the good news of salvation, some Gentiles believed and found salvation.

Luke 7:11

The location of the village of Nain is uncertain. It might be the modern town of Nein, 9.6 kilometers (6 miles) southeast of Nazareth.

Luke 7:11–17

Jesus raised three people from the dead:

- the dead man in this passage,
- Jairus's daughter (8:40–56), and
- Lazarus (John 11:38–44).

Jesus has power over life and death (compare 1 Kings 17:17–24; 2 Kings 4:18–37).

Luke 7:12

- a dead man being carried out: In Judaism, a large crowd of mourners and intense wailing signified great love for the person who died. In some cases, people hired people to mourn.
- Widows were the most vulnerable members of society, and God had special concern for them (Exodus 22:22; Deuteronomy 10:18; 27:19). This widow's only son was her means of support and hope for the future. His death was a terrible loss (see Jeremiah 6:26; Amos 8:10; Zechariah 12:10).

Luke 7:13–14

Here, the word coffin may refer to:

- a long box in which someone is buried, or
- a funeral bier (a frame or portable stand used to carry the coffin or the body of the person who had died).

A Jew became ceremonially unclean by touching a dead body, coffin, or bier (Leviticus 21:1, 11–12). But

when Jesus touched the man with leprosy, he did not become unclean (Luke 5:13). Instead, he replaced disease and death with cleansing and life.

Luke 7:16

A great prophet: Jesus was like the Old Testament prophets Elijah and Elisha.

Luke 7:18–23

John's disciples: See study note on 5:33. John was now in prison (3:19–20). He wondered if Jesus was truly the Christ since Jesus did not act like a powerful political king who would defeat the Romans. In response, Jesus defined his role as God's chosen king.

Luke 7:22

The blind receive sight, the lame walk: The prophet Isaiah describes God's salvation as the renewal of his fallen creation (Isaiah 26:19; 29:18–19; 35:5–6; 61:1–2). Jesus did not come to end Roman rule over Judea. This may explain why he leaves out the words "proclaim liberty to the captives" when he quotes Isaiah 61:1. He came for a greater purpose: to reverse the effects of sin and death.

Luke 7:23

Blessed is the one who does not fall away on account of Me: The blessing is for those who are willing to leave behind their own expectations about the Christ and accept Jesus's path of suffering.

Luke 7:27

The quotation is from Malachi 3:1. In Malachi 4:5–6, this messenger is identified as the prophet Elijah. Though John denied that he was Elijah (John 1:21–23), he came in the spirit and power of Elijah to prepare the way for God's chosen king (Luke 1:17; see 3:4–6).

Luke 7:28

Jesus praised John as the greatest person who ever lived under the old covenant. But even the least person in the kingdom of God is greater than John.

The blessings of the new covenant are

- free and complete forgiveness of sins,
- the indwelling presence of the Holy Spirit, and
- intimate knowledge of God.

These blessings give believers in Jesus a new and greater position than even John enjoyed.

Luke 7:31–35

To what, then, can I compare the men of this generation?: Jesus compares Israel to fickle children in the marketplace who play games of make-believe. They called John the Baptist to dance (a wedding game), but the serious prophet refused. Instead, he called them to mourn and repent of their sins.

Then they called on Jesus to mourn (a funeral game), but he was the bridegroom who announced the joyful celebration banquet of the kingdom of God. It would not have been appropriate for him to mourn (compare Mark 2:19–20).

Luke 7:33

John the Baptist did not spend his time eating bread or drinking wine. He lived a simple life of self-denial that fit his role as a prophet. He announced God's kingdom, the coming judgment of God, and the need for repentance and cleansing from sin.

Luke 7:35

Wisdom is vindicated: This means wisdom is proven right by the lives of those who follow it. The book of Proverbs describes wisdom as a woman who calls God's people to a life of godliness and obedience to God's commands (Proverbs 1:20–33; 8:1–9:6). Wisdom's children are those who live righteously, as God's word instructs.

Luke 7:36

one of the Pharisees invited Jesus to eat with him: Jesus has more positive contact with the Pharisees in Luke than in the other Gospels. He was a respected teacher and healer, so it is not surprising that this Pharisee invited him to dinner. Not all Pharisees opposed Jesus. Some were interested in his teaching, while others were simply curious about him.

Luke 7:36–50

What Jesus said in 7:35 is shown in this story by one of "wisdom's children" (see study note on 7:35). She is a repentant sinner (a person who turns away from sin). She shows deep gratitude for the forgiveness she has received.

Luke 7:37

- a sinful woman: This suggests she was known in the community as a person with a bad moral reputation. Some people think she may have been a prostitute, but the passage does not state this explicitly.

- Alabaster is a soft stone, often white, yellow, or red. People used it to make costly containers, such as this beautiful jar.

Luke 7:38

- she stood behind Him: At a banquet, people ate while lying on their sides around a low table, with their feet stretched out behind them. Because of this, the woman could not reach the head of Jesus to anoint him (to pour oil on him as a sign of honor), so she poured the perfume on his feet.

wipe them with her hair: In that culture, a woman normally kept her hair covered in public. Letting her hair down could bring shame and even give a husband reason for divorce. By wiping the feet of Jesus with her hair and kissing them, she showed deep respect and honor. She set aside normal social rules because she was so thankful.

Luke 7:40

But Jesus answered him: See study note on 5:22.

Luke 7:41

five hundred denarii: This was nearly two years' wages for a person who earned a living by working different jobs each day. In first-century Galilee, people who were poor often owed large debts to people who were wealthy.

Luke 7:43

the one who was forgiven more: Those who had been forgiven the most responded with greater gratitude and love. The woman did her extraordinary act of sacrificial love because Jesus had forgiven her sins.

Luke 7:44–46

Simon failed to show Jesus the usual acts of hospitality (ways to welcome a guest). The roads were dusty, so a servant would normally wash a guest's feet. People in the Middle East often greet guests with a kiss on both cheeks, and this is still common today. Hosts also put olive oil on a guest's head as a way to show honor and respect.

Luke 7:47

for she has loved much: It was not that her great love for Jesus caused him to forgive her, but that the forgiveness she had already received from Jesus caused her love.

Luke 8:2

Magdalene means "from Magdala." Madgala was a village north of Tiberias on the western side of the Sea of Galilee. Mary Magdalene plays an important role in the accounts of the burial and resurrection of Jesus (24:10; Mark 15:40, 47; John 19:25; 20:1, 18). Some people have said that Mary Magdalene was the woman in Luke 7:36–38. This idea has led to the belief that she was a former prostitute. However, the Bible does not say this, and there is no clear evidence for it.

Luke 8:2–3

as well as some women: In the time of Jesus, Jewish rabbis (religious teachers with authority) did not have women disciples. So this was unusual. Some of these women, like Joanna, came from wealthy families and gave financial support to the ministry of Jesus.

Luke 8:4–15

The parable of the farmer scattering seed shows that people respond in different ways to the message of Jesus about God's kingdom.

Luke 8:5

- A farmer would scatter seed and then plow it into the soil.
- The seed that fell on a walking path did not remain in the soil, so it was stepped on and eaten by birds.

Luke 8:6

fell on rocky ground: There was often a limestone layer 23 to 30.5 centimeters (9 to 12 inches) under the soil, so that the rain was trapped and seed sprouted quickly in the moist soil. But when the rain stopped, the sun evaporated the trapped moisture and the plant died.

Luke 8:7

fell among thorns: One type of weed looked very much like wheat as it grew, but it had larger roots and took away the moisture and nutrients that the wheat needed.

Luke 8:8

He who has ears to hear, let him hear: This meant everyone who was willing to listen.

Luke 8:10

- The mysteries of the kingdom of God: What was hidden in the past about God's reign was now revealed through the words and actions of Jesus.

- though seeing ... they may not understand: This quote is from the Greek version of Isaiah 6:9. This passage appears often in the New Testament to explain why Israel rejected the gospel (see also Matthew 13:14–15; Mark 4:12; John 12:40; Acts 28:26–27). In its original context, the passage refers to God's certain judgment of Israel at the hands of the Assyrians. Israel's sin and rebelliousness had taken them beyond the point of no return, so God blinded them in preparation for judgment. Those who rejected the message of Jesus were unable to see the truth clearly.

Luke 8:11

the seed is the word of God: This means Jesus is preaching the good news about God's kingdom.

Luke 8:12

Satan tries to stop those who have yet to trust in Christ from understanding the truth.

Luke 8:13

Deep roots indicate spiritual depth and maturity. The Greek word translated testing can also mean "temptation" or "trials."

Luke 8:16–17

A small clay lamp was filled with olive oil and placed in a space in the wall (an alcove). The message of Jesus gives light to those who listen, and it shows their true attitudes.

Luke 8:18

Pay attention, therefore, to how you listen: Compare with Proverbs 9:9.

Luke 8:19–20

Jesus had four brothers:

- James,
- Joseph,
- Judas, and
- Simon.

The Gospels also mention sisters, but not how many Jesus had (Matthew 13:55; Mark 6:3). These children were probably born to Joseph and Mary after the virgin birth of Jesus. However, some Christians believe that Mary remained a virgin throughout her life. According to this view, Joseph was a widower who already had children from an earlier marriage when he married Mary.

Luke 8:21

those who hear God's word and carry it out: Jesus was not rejecting his family. He was saying that spiritual relationships, like being part of God's family, are more important than family bonds.

Luke 8:22–25

When Jesus calmed the windstorm, he showed his control over the elements. This act suggested he was God, since God controls the seas (see Psalms 65:7; 89:9; 104:6–7; 107:23–32).

Luke 8:23

A powerful windstorm came down on the lake. Severe storms often occur on the Sea of Galilee, which is in a valley surrounded by high hills.

Luke 8:24

Jesus got up and rebuked the wind and the raging waters: Just as Jesus rebuked demons and diseases (4:39, 41), he showed his authority by rebuking the sea (compare 2 Samuel 22:16; Psalms 18:15; 104:7; 106:9; Isaiah 50:2; Nahum 1:4).

Luke 8:26

the region of the Gerasenes: Gerasa was a city in the Decapolis, located about 48 kilometers (30 miles) southeast of the Sea of Galilee. Jesus traveled to this mainly Gentile (non-Jewish) area on purpose to teach and help the people there.

Luke 8:26–39

Jesus had commanded the unclean spirit to come out of the man: This is known as an exorcism. This story showed the power Jesus has over spiritual forces. It also contrasted the healed man's faith and commitment to Jesus with the fear and rejection of people in the town.

Luke 8:27

he stayed in the tombs: Touching a tomb or a dead body made a Jew unclean, or ceremonially defiled. Jesus willingly entered this unclean place to rescue a person enslaved by Satan.

Luke 8:28

Jesus, Son of the Most High God: See study notes on 4:34, 41.

Luke 8:29

unclean spirit: The word unclean means not fit to be in God's presence. An unclean spirit is a spirit that opposes God and does not belong near him (see also study note on 4:33).

Luke 8:30

A Roman legion included about 6,000 soldiers. This number shows that the man had many demons.

Luke 8:31

the Abyss: The Greek word abussos means "bottomless." It often refers to the prison of evil spirits or fallen angels under the surface of the world (Revelation 9:1–2, 11; 11:7; 17:8; 20:1, 3; compare 2 Peter 2:4). The metaphor comes from the apparently bottomless depth of the ocean (the ancients had no means for sounding the ocean depths, so to them it was bottomless).

Luke 8:32

a large herd of pigs: Jews considered pigs to be ceremonially unclean animals. This indicates that the people in this area were Gentiles. The spiritually unclean demons were only suitable to be in pigs.

Luke 8:35

sitting at Jesus' feet: The man sat in the position of a disciple, indicating his willingness to follow Jesus (see 8:37).

Luke 8:37

asked Jesus to depart from them: The power of Jesus over spiritual forces scared the people. Losing their pigs made them angry. Their rejection contrasts with the faith of the healed man.

Luke 8:39

Return home: The role of disciples is to proclaim to the world what Jesus has done for them.

Luke 8:40–56

These two accounts of healing show that Jesus has authority over disease and death. They also show the power of faith.

Luke 8:41

synagogue leader: The leader of the local synagogue was the officer who maintained the local synagogue and organized services (see also 8:49; 13:14; Acts 13:15; 18:8, 17).

Luke 8:43

bleeding: The woman might have suffered from ongoing bleeding from her monthly cycle. The suffering was both physical and spiritual. According to the law of Moses, such bleeding made the woman ceremonially unclean. This would prevent her from participating in community worship (Leviticus 15:25–30).

Luke 8:44

the fringe of His cloak: This likely refers to the little pieces of material (tassels) that pious Jews wore on the edges of their clothing (see Numbers 15:38–39; Deuteronomy 22:12).

Luke 8:45

Who touched Me?: Jesus recognized the touch of faith by a needy person.

Luke 8:48

your faith has healed you. Go in peace: Jesus also said this to the woman who anointed his feet (7:50). The Greek word translated here as healed can mean spiritual or physical salvation. Peace (compare to the Hebrew word shalom) means wholeness, not only the lack of conflict (see 1:79; 2:14, 29; 7:50; 19:38, 42; 24:36).

Luke 8:51

Peter, John, and James formed a close group within the disciples of Jesus (see 5:1–11; 9:28; Mark 14:32–33).

Luke 8:52

- everyone was weeping and mourning: See study note on 7:12.
- she is not dead but asleep: Jesus emphasized that the girl's condition was temporary. For Christians, death is like being asleep for a temporary period (compare John 11:11; Acts 7:60; 13:36; 1 Corinthians 11:30; 15:6, 18, 20, 51; 1 Thessalonians 4:14–15; 5:10).

Luke 8:55

Her spirit returned: Like the raising of the widow's son (7:15), the girl's normal mortal life was restored. At the final resurrection, believers will receive glorified bodies that do not die (see study note on 24:39).

Luke 8:56

not to tell anyone: See "The Secret of the Messiah" Theme Note.

Luke 9:1–6

Jesus now sent his 12 disciples to announce the kingdom of God and demonstrate its authority by casting out demons and healing the sick. Jesus was training them to carry on his work after he was gone.

Luke 9:3

Take nothing for the journey: They were to depend on God and on the kindness of the people they served.

Luke 9:4

Whatever house you enter, stay there: They were to develop lasting relationships and be content without seeking better lodging or provisions.

Luke 9:5

shake the dust off your feet: Using a symbol of rejection, they were to leave such a town to the judgment it deserved.

Luke 9:8

Jews expected the prophet Elijah would arrive before God's final judgment (see study note on 1:17). Some Jews expected a prophet like Moses would come (Deuteronomy 18:15).

Luke 9:9

I beheaded John: See Mark 6:14–29.

Luke 9:10

- He withdrew: Jesus knew the disciples needed a time to focus on spiritual matters.
- Bethsaida was on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee, east of the Jordan River. It was the hometown of Peter, Andrew, and Philip (John 1:44; 12:21).

Luke 9:10–17

The feeding of the 5,000 recalls God's miraculous feeding of Israel with manna in the wilderness (Exodus 16; see also 2 Kings 4:42–44). It points forward to God's final salvation as a great feast for all nations (Isaiah 25:6–8; 65:13–14; Luke 14:15–24).

Luke 9:11

He welcomed them: Jesus wanted to go away in private with his disciples, but he had compassion on the crowds and ministered to them.

Luke 9:13

You give them something to eat: After their ministry of healing the sick and casting out demons, Jesus wanted the disciples to demonstrate faith in God's ability to feed the crowds.

Luke 9:17

twelve basketfuls of broken pieces that were left over: God abundantly provides for his people.

Luke 9:18–27

Peter's confession that Jesus was the Christ (or Messiah) marked a turning point. Until then, Jesus had shown his authority as God's promised leader through miracles. Now he began to explain that the Messiah would suffer in an unexpected way.

Jesus accepted this confession, but he made it clear that his role as Messiah would include suffering and death. He also called his disciples to follow him no matter the cost.

Luke 9:19

others say Elijah: See study note on 9:8.

Luke 9:20

The Christ: This phrase could be translated "the LORD's anointed," a title for the king of Israel (1 Samuel 24:6, 10; 2 Samuel 19:21; Psalm 2:2). David was the LORD's anointed, and so was the Christ.

Luke 9:21–22

not to tell this to anyone: Jesus did not want to inspire the people to fight against Rome. His mission was to suffer, die, and rise from the dead.

Luke 9:22

- must suffer many things: This was the first prophecy of Jesus about his coming death in Jerusalem (see 9:44; 17:25; 18:31–34). Jesus would fulfill the prophecies in Isaiah 52:13–53:12. These prophecies describe the Lord's servant (the Messiah) who offers himself to save God's people. These events were part of God's purpose and plan.

Despite opposition from human beings and from the spiritual forces of Satan, God works through the actions of human beings to accomplish his purposes. Though wicked men plotted against Jesus and put him to death, God accomplished salvation by raising Jesus from the dead (Luke 24:7, 26–27, 44–47; Acts 2:23–24; 3:18; 4:28).

- chief priests: Though Israel had only one high priest, the upper-class priests were the wealthy ruling class. They served on the Sanhedrin (the

main Jewish council) and held positions of power in Jerusalem.

Luke 9:23

take up his cross daily: This did not simply mean carrying a heavy burden. It meant dying a violent death on a cross. Believers must be fully willing to die to themselves and live for God, even if following him costs them their lives.

Luke 9:23–27

If anyone wants to come after me: After predicting his own suffering and death, Jesus taught that all who follow him must also experience death to self.

Luke 9:24

whoever wants to save his life: Trying to keep control of your own life instead of trusting God suggests that putting yourself in God's place denies that Jesus is king. The result is that a person will lose true life, especially at the final judgment (9:26; John 12:25).

Luke 9:26

the Son of Man ... when He comes in His glory: See Daniel 7:13–14; "The Son of Man" Theme Note.

Luke 9:27

This difficult verse might refer to:

1. the second coming of Christ;
2. the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70;
3. the resurrection of Jesus; or
4. the transfiguration (when the appearance of Jesus changed and his glory was shown), which immediately follows in 9:28–36.

The last possibility is the most likely.

Luke 9:28

- About eight days later: Mark's Gospel says "after six days," referring to full days. Luke only includes parts of days.
- Peter, John, and James were the disciples who were closest to Jesus (see also 8:51; Mark 14:32–33).
- a mountain: The traditional site of the transfiguration is Mount Tabor in southern Galilee. Some people think it was Mount Hermon, because it is closer to Caesarea Philippi, where Peter declared that Jesus is the Christ (Luke 9:18–27).

Luke 9:28–36

At the transfiguration, Jesus revealed his true glory in the presence of three disciples. This confirmed Peter's belief that Jesus was the Christ. Moses and Elijah confirmed that Jesus fulfilled the Old Testament prophecies about the Messiah (the Christ, God's chosen king).

Luke 9:29

His clothes became radiantly white (literally became bright as a flash of lightning): The glory of Jesus shone through his human body (compare Ezekiel 1:4; Daniel 7:9; see also Exodus 34:29).

Luke 9:31

His departure: The Greek word exodos means "departure." In the Old Testament, the exodus from Egypt was God's great act of salvation. Similarly, in the New Testament, the departure of Jesus from this world was God's greatest act of salvation. This includes his death, resurrection, and ascension (going up into heaven). Jesus would accomplish a new and greater exodus.

Luke 9:33

Let us put up three shelters: The Greek word translated shelter (skēnē) is the same word used in the Greek Old Testament for the tabernacle. This was Israel's tent for worship that they moved with them as they traveled in the wilderness. It also refers to the temporary shelters that Jews used during the Feast of Booths (Leviticus 23:42; Nehemiah 8:14–17). Peter might have wanted to extend the event by providing a place for Jesus, Moses, and Elijah to stay.

Luke 9:34

and enveloped them: In the Bible, clouds often cover or hide God's presence (Exodus 16:10; 19:9; 24:16).

Luke 9:35

- The voice ... from the cloud: This reminds audiences of God's voice at the baptism of Jesus (3:22).
- whom I have chosen: This refers to Isaiah 42:1, showing Jesus is the Lord's suffering "Servant."
- Listen to Him!: This is from Deuteronomy 18:15, identifying Jesus as the prophet to come who would be like Moses (see Acts 3:22; 7:37).

Luke 9:38

my only child: Losing an only son was especially disappointing because it meant no one could continue the family name (compare 7:12; see Genesis 22:16; 1 Kings 17:17–24; Jeremiah 6:26; Amos 8:10; Zechariah 12:10).

Luke 9:39

A spirit keeps seizing him: Demons sometimes cause physical sickness, such as not being able to walk or not being able to speak (13:11; 11:14).

Luke 9:41

O unbelieving and perverse generation!: It is unclear whether Jesus was speaking to the disciples or to the people as a whole.

Luke 9:44

See study note on 9:22.

Luke 9:45

It was veiled from them: Its meaning was hidden from them. The disciples were often slow to understand because they could not fully see the truth until after the resurrection (see study note on Mark 6:52).

Luke 9:46

Jesus had just told his disciples that he would suffer and die. Yet they began to argue about which of them was the greatest. This showed surprising pride and a lack of concern for what Jesus had just said.

Luke 9:46–50

The disciples did not understand that Jesus would soon die, which was now seen in their pride and selfish attitude.

Luke 9:47

Jesus, knowing the thoughts of their hearts: See 5:22; 7:39–40.

Luke 9:48

- Whoever welcomes this little child: To welcome means to honor and treat as an equal. This statement is surprising because, in the time of Jesus, children had no social status in the community. People viewed children as the property of their parents. Jesus took the lowest and most vulnerable members of society and announced that welcoming them was the same as welcoming him.
- in My name: This means “as my representative.”
- whoever is the least among all of you, he is the greatest: True leadership in the kingdom of Jesus comes from serving others, not the exercise of power (see also Mark 10:42–45).

Luke 9:50

for whoever is not against you is for you: Although the man who was casting out demons was not one of the twelve disciples, Jesus said he should not be stopped because he was also proclaiming the message of the kingdom. This statement was a proverb (a wise saying), not an absolute rule, since Jesus made the opposite statement in 11:23. Wisdom is needed to apply a proverb correctly in each situation.

Luke 9:51

Jesus resolutely set out for Jerusalem: Even though the route was not direct, Jerusalem was his final destination.

Luke 9:51–19.44

The journey to Jerusalem marked a new stage in the mission of Jesus as the Messiah, which would include suffering. During this time, he prepared his disciples for what was ahead, and the Jewish leaders opposed him more and more.

Luke 9:52–53

a village of the Samaritans: Jews and Samaritans had a long history of conflict and ethnic prejudice. They hated each other (see study note on 10:33). The Samaritans worshiped on Mount Gerizim and probably assumed that Jesus was traveling to Jerusalem to worship there.

Luke 9:54

call down fire from heaven to consume them: Some ancient Greek versions add as Elijah did. The prophet Elijah called down fire from heaven three times against God’s enemies (1 Kings 18:38; 2 Kings 1:1–17). James and John, in their enthusiasm, wanted to do the same.

Luke 9:57–62

As he traveled toward Jerusalem to suffer and die, Jesus explained the cost to those who wished to follow him.

Luke 9:58

no place to lay His head: Any disciple of Jesus must be ready to go anywhere and to give up home and security.

Luke 9:59

let me go and bury my father: Respect for parents was a very important value in first-century Israel. Among

other things, this meant providing them with an honorable burial. Jesus called for a commitment that took priority over all human relationships.

Luke 9:61–62

- Let me bid farewell to my family: This statement is similar to the prophet Elisha's request to Elijah (1 Kings 19:19–20). Jesus asked for an even greater commitment from his followers.
- puts his hand to the plow and then looks back: Farmers in the ancient world guided a light plow, a tool used to prepare soil for planting, with one hand and the oxen (work animals used for farming) with the other. Looking away would cause the plow to turn away.

For a believer, looking back meant placing earthly concerns ahead of God.

Luke 10:1–20

the Lord appointed seventy-two others: The mission of the twelve disciples represented the ministry of Jesus to Israel (9:1–6). This mission represented his outreach to the Gentiles. The number 72 represents the nations of the world. Genesis 10 lists 70 nations in the Hebrew text, but the Greek Old Testament (the Septuagint) lists 72.

Luke, who used the Septuagint, likely wrote 72, and then a later scribe changed it to match the Hebrew text. The main idea is that the good news about Jesus and the kingdom of God is for both Jews and Gentiles.

Luke 10:2

The harvest refers to people who need to hear the good news about Jesus and be gathered to God's presence (compare Isaiah 27:12). There was urgency to the task, just as crops have to be brought in at the exact time when they are ripe. More workers were needed.

Luke 10:3

lambs among wolves: are not to dominate others, but to sacrifice themselves for the benefit of others. This makes them vulnerable (see Jeremiah 5:6; Ezekiel 22:27; Habakkuk 1:8; Zephaniah 3:3). But the good shepherd protects them from the wolves (Psalm 23:1).

Luke 10:4

- Carry no purse: Compare 9:3. The disciples of Jesus were to depend on God and on the help of those whom they served.
- Do not greet anyone along the road: This did not mean being unfriendly, but remaining focused on the task Jesus had given them.

Luke 10:5

God's peace means spiritual blessings and becoming whole. This is known as the shalom of God (see study note on 8:48).

Luke 10:7

- Stay at the same house: See study note on 9:4.
- For the worker is worthy of his wages: Those who minister for Jesus should receive compensation from those they serve (see also 1 Corinthians 9:14; 1 Timothy 5:18).

Luke 10:9

- Jesus gave the same mission to the twelve disciples (see 9:1).
- Heal the sick: Healing was a sign of salvation (Isaiah 29:18–19; 35:5). It was physical evidence that the kingdom of God was present (see study note on Luke 7:22).

Luke 10:11

See study note on 9:5.

Luke 10:12

God destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah because of their wickedness (Genesis 18:16–19:29).

Luke 10:13

- Chorazin and Bethsaida were towns where Jesus taught. They were on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee.
- Tyre and Sidon were Gentile cities in Phoenicia, on the Mediterranean coast north of Galilee. The prophets had delivered messages of judgment against their evil behavior (Isaiah 23; Ezekiel 28).

Luke 10:15

- Capernaum was where Jesus worked during his ministry in Galilee. This town witnessed many of his miracles (see 4:31–41).
- to Hades: Though Capernaum was blessed by the Christ's presence, it would be judged for its pride and rejection of Jesus.

Luke 10:18

I saw Satan fall like lightning from heaven: See Revelation 12:7–12.

Luke 10:19

Snakes and scorpions were symbols of danger and evil (see Num 21:6–9; Deut 8:15; 1 Kgs 12:14; Isa 11:8; Ezek 2:6). Satan is the ancient serpent who tempted Eve (Gen 3:13–14; Rom 16:20; Rev 12:9; 20:2), and demonic forces are described as scorpions (Rev 9:3–4). • Nothing will injure you: This didn't mean that Jesus' followers should take dangerous chances. The point is that God protects his servants (e.g., Acts 28:3–6).

Luke 10:20

- Disciples should not rejoice in their spiritual power, but in the greatness of God who freely gives them salvation.
- your names are written in heaven: For the record of salvation in heaven's books, see Exodus 32:32–33; Psalm 69:28; Isaiah 4:3; Daniel 12:1; Malachi 3:16–17; Philippians 4:3; Hebrews 12:23; Revelation 3:5; 13:8; 17:8; 20:12, 15; 21:27.

Luke 10:21

You have hidden these things: God uses simple things that a child can understand to shame those who think themselves wise but are foolish in God's eyes (see Isaiah 29:14; 1 Corinthians 1:18–31).

Luke 10:22

The Father and the Son share an intimate relationship. Jesus came to earth to reveal the Father to a lost world (see John 1:1–18).

Luke 10:23

see what you see: The disciples saw God's promised salvation come. They saw the kingdom of God begin.

Luke 10:25

an expert in the law: See study note on 5:17.

Luke 10:27

Love the Lord your God: Jesus identified Deuteronomy 6:5 and Leviticus 19:18 as the two most important commandments (Mark 12:28–34). Deuteronomy 6:5 is part of the prayer called the Shema, which every Jew was to repeat daily.

Luke 10:28

Do this and you will live: Jesus was not suggesting that people would be saved by their works. Instead, such love expresses genuine faith and devotion to the Lord.

Luke 10:29

Who is my neighbor?: A neighbor, in this context, was normally identified as a fellow Israelite.

Luke 10:30

The road from Jerusalem to Jericho declined 1,000 meters (3,300 feet) through rugged terrain where robbers often waited for travelers.

Luke 10:30–37

This parable shows that true neighbors love even their enemies (10:29). True faith is not based on a person's ethnic background or religious group, but on loving God and loving others.

Luke 10:31

- a priest: Priests were descendants of Aaron from the tribe of Levi (Exodus 28:1–3). They served in the temple and offered sacrifices to God.
- passed by: If Aa priest or a Levite touched a dead body, they would become ceremonially unclean and could not serve in the temple. This priest was unwilling to risk ritual impurity by helping a person in serious trouble.

Luke 10:32

a Levite: Levites were members of the tribe of Levi. They were not given a tribal homeland in Israel but were dedicated to God (Numbers 3:41, 45; 8:18; 35:2–3; Deuteronomy 18:1; Joshua 14:3). They assisted priests in temple service.

Luke 10:33

a Samaritan: This unexpected change in the story probably surprised the listeners. Jews and Samaritans hated each other (see 9:52–53; 17:16; John 4:4–42). After Assyria conquered the northern kingdom of Israel, Assyrian settlers married Israelites who remained in Samaria. Their descendants became known as Samaritans.

Later, after the Judeans returned from Babylon, conflict grew between Jews and Samaritans (Ezra 4:1–24). The Samaritans built their own temple on Mount Gerizim. They also used their own version of the Pentateuch, the first five books of the Bible, as Scripture.

This hatred grew worse when the Jewish king John Hyrcanus attacked the Samaritans and destroyed their temple on Mount Gerizim. This happened around 128 BC. Because of this long hatred, no first-century Jew would expect a despised Samaritan to help a wounded

Jew. But in God's kingdom, a despised foreigner becomes a true neighbor who helps!

Luke 10:34

Oil calmed the wound, and wine helped keep away infection.

Luke 10:38–42

Martha ... Mary: These sisters and their brother Lazarus were good friends of Jesus. They lived in Bethany, east of Jerusalem (see John 11:1).

Luke 10:39

Mary ... sat at the Lord's feet: She took the position of a disciple (compare Acts 22:3). Rabbis (Jewish religious teachers with authority) usually did not have female disciples.

Luke 10:40

Martha was distracted by all the preparations to be made: Hospitality was highly valued, and Martha was doing what people expected a woman to do in that culture. She was upset that Mary was not helping.

Luke 10:42

only one thing is necessary: Mary has discovered it. The words of Jesus were surprising. Women were expected to serve in the home, and they were not allowed to learn from a rabbi as disciples. Jesus affirmed Mary's desire to be his disciple.

Luke 11:1

praying: See study note on 3:21.

Luke 11:2–4

When you pray, say: The "Lord's Prayer" was the way Jesus wanted his disciples to pray.

Luke 11:4

And lead us not into temptation: This phrase is difficult in Greek. God does not tempt his people (James 1:13). But testing is part of Christian growth (James 1:2–4), so this raises a question: Should believers pray to avoid testing?

The phrase probably means "protect us when we face temptation."

Luke 11:6

a friend of mine has come to me on a journey: Standards of hospitality in first-century Jewish culture required a host to find adequate provisions for a visitor.

Luke 11:8

because of the man's persistence (or in order to avoid shame, or so his reputation will not be damaged): The man who refused to get up would also be shamed, because hospitality was a duty in that community. In the same way, God protects his good name by caring for his people.

Luke 11:11–12

a fish ... an egg: These were common foods. A scorpion can look like an egg when it curls into a ball. A snake or scorpion in place of food would be a cruel trick, giving something dangerous instead of a good meal. No loving father would do that.

Luke 11:13

give the Holy Spirit: The parallel passage in the Gospel of Matthew says that the Father will "give good things" (Matthew 7:11). Luke highlights the greatest of these gifts: the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit guides believers, gives them power to serve God, and marks them as belonging to God in salvation. Luke especially emphasizes the work of the Holy Spirit throughout Luke and Acts.

Luke 11:14

a demon possessed a man who could not speak: In the Gospels, physical disease or disability was sometimes caused by demons.

Luke 11:14–32

Jesus faced two challenges. He answered the first, an accusation that he was driving out demons by Satan's power (11:15), in 11:17–26. The second was a demand for "a sign from heaven" (11:16). He answered this in 11:29–32.

Luke 11:15

Beelzebul: This means "Baal, the prince." It was originally the name of a false god worshiped in Canaan. Later, people used it as a name for Satan. The Jews mocked the name, calling him Beelzebub, which means "lord of the flies."

Luke 11:17

- Knowing their thoughts: See 5:22; 7:40; 9:47.
- Every kingdom divided against itself: Jesus first responded to the accusation by saying it is impossible

for him to work for Satan. He was destroying Satan's kingdom by driving out demons.

Luke 11:20

The kingdom of God has come upon you: When Jesus drove out demons, he showed that the kingdom of God was present.

Luke 11:21–22

The strong man is Satan. Jesus is someone stronger. By driving out demons, Jesus showed that he was defeating Satan and taking back what belonged to him. This includes people Satan had kept in bondage (compare Isaiah 49:24–26).

Luke 11:23

He who is not with Me is against Me: See study note on 9:50.

Luke 11:26

seven other spirits: Seven may indicate completeness, meaning that the man was completely under their power, or it could simply indicate an overwhelming force.

Luke 11:28

Blessed rather: Jesus again affirmed that our spiritual life and our relationship with God are more important than physical ancestry and family relationships (compare 8:21).

Luke 11:29–30

The sign of Jonah might refer to the resurrection of Jesus. Jonah's time in the fish was a sign to the Ninevites that God had sent him, similar to the time Jesus spent in the grave ("in the heart of the earth"; Matthew 12:40). It could also mean that both Jonah and Jesus preached God's warning to repent (see Luke 11:32).

Luke 11:31

South: The Old Testament identifies this place as Sheba, a kingdom in southern Arabia. The queen traveled a long distance to hear King Solomon's wisdom (1 Kings 10:1–13; 2 Chronicles 9:1–12).

Luke 11:33

No one lights a lamp and puts it in a cellar or under a basket: See study note on 8:16–17.

Luke 11:35–36

Light and darkness are metaphors for good and evil (John 1:5; 3:19; 8:12; 12:35; Acts 26:18; Romans 13:12; 2 Corinthians 4:6; 6:14; Ephesians 5:8; 1 Thessalonians 5:5; 1 Peter 2:9; 1 John 1:5; 2:8–9).

Luke 11:37

a Pharisee invited Him to dine with him: See study note on 7:36.

Luke 11:38

first wash before the meal: The Pharisees had developed elaborate washing rituals to ensure ceremonial purity (see Mark 7:1–5).

Luke 11:39

The Pharisees had very detailed rules for washing cups and dishes in order to be religiously clean. These rules were about ceremonial cleansing (a special washing required by religious law).

Jesus said they cleaned only the outside of the cup. By this, he meant they carefully followed outward rules. But inside, they were still unclean. They kept sin and wrong desires in their inner lives (their thoughts and motives).

Luke 11:41

give as alms: Giving to those in need is an outward action. Such actions reveal internal righteousness (a right relationship with God).

Luke 11:42

pay tithes of mint, rue, and every herb: The law required tithing (giving one tenth to God; see Leviticus 27:30–33; Numbers 18:21–32; Deuteronomy 14:22–29; 2 Chronicles 31:5–12). The Pharisees were careful to tithe everything correctly. But they ignored what was more important: justice and the love of God.

Luke 11:42–52

Woe to you Pharisees! Woes are the opposite of blessings (see study note on 6:24–26). Jesus pronounced six woes. Three were against the Pharisees (11:42, 43, 44) and three were against the teachers of religious law (11:46, 47, 52).

Luke 11:43

- The elders of the synagogues had special seats of honor.
- The respectful greetings were honorable ways of addressing social and religious superiors. For exam-

ple, people might use a special title when speaking to a leader, teacher, or judge to show respect.

Luke 11:44

unmarked graves: Touching a grave or a dead body made a Jew ceremonially unclean. Jesus accused the religious leaders of being a defiling influence rather than a purifying one. This was a strongly offensive accusation (11:45).

Luke 11:45

experts in the law: The experts in religious law were closely aligned with the Pharisees and shared the same zeal for keeping the law of Moses.

Luke 11:46

heavy burdens: This refers to the oral tradition with all its intricate details on living according to torah (God's instruction in the books of Moses). The oral tradition placed a great burden upon the Jewish people.

Luke 11:48

They killed the prophets: See 1 Kings 19:10, 14; Nehemiah 9:26; Jeremiah 2:30; 26:20–24. Luke presents Jesus as the suffering prophet (Luke 4:22–24). The suffering prophet is a prophet sent by God who is rejected and suffers. Luke shows that Jesus fits this pattern.

Luke 11:49

The quotation is not explicitly from the Old Testament.

Luke 11:51

from the blood of Abel to the blood of Zechariah: Abel's murder by his brother Cain was the first murder recorded in the Old Testament (Genesis 4:8). The stoning of Zechariah, son of Jehoiada (2 Chronicles 24:20–22), was the last, since Chronicles is the last book in the Hebrew Bible.

Luke 11:52

the key to knowledge: See Matthew 16:19; 23:13.

Luke 12:1

Yeast spreads through dough until it is entirely leavened. Leaven became a symbol of sin's spreading power (Exodus 12:14–20; 1 Corinthians 5:6). Like yeast, the hypocrisy of the Pharisees would spread until it affected all the people.

Luke 12:2–3

These verses warn against hypocrisy (pretending to be good or righteous). All thoughts will be revealed by God, who knows all things and will judge every human being (Job 10:4–7; 11:11; Psalms 11:4; 33:15; 139:12; Proverbs 15:3).

Luke 12:5

hell (Greek Gehenna): Gehenna was the Valley of Hinnom, a ravine on the southwest side of Jerusalem. It became a picture of hell because some Israelites had sacrificed their children there to false gods (Jeremiah 32:35).

Jesus taught his disciples to never be afraid of enemies who can only take away their life on earth. Instead, they should fear God, who alone has authority over final judgment.

Luke 12:6

Each of the two pennies was worth about half an hour of work for a person who earned a living by working day jobs.

Luke 12:8

will also confess him before the angels of God: At the final judgment (see Daniel 7:7–14).

Luke 12:10

The Holy Spirit guides people to God. A person who speaks against (blasphemes) the Holy Spirit and rejects the Spirit's witness about Jesus also rejects God. This is the unforgivable sin (see study notes on Matthew 12:31–32).

Luke 12:11–12

brought before synagogues: Jesus predicted persecution from Jews in the synagogues and from Gentile rulers and authorities. Paul and other apostles faced both kinds of persecution throughout Acts.

Luke 12:13

tell my brother to divide the inheritance with me: In Judaism, the oldest son received twice as much of the family estate (Deuteronomy 21:17). He was responsible for dividing up the rest after his father's death. This younger brother wanted his share of the estate (compare Luke 15:11–32).

Luke 12:13–21

This parable shows the danger of trusting in riches instead of in God.

Luke 12:15

Guard yourselves against every form of greed: See Exodus 20:17; Deuteronomy 5:21; Job 31:24–25; Psalm 49; Ecclesiastes 2:1–11.

Luke 12:16–20

On the surface, the rich man's plan seemed wise. But he thought only about himself (compare Ecclesiastes 5:10). He did not think about giving any of his crops to people in need. He assumed that his wealth would last. He only wanted a place to store it and did not include God in his plans (see James 4:13–17). So God's judgment against him was just.

Luke 12:19–20

- myself (Literally soul): The man was speaking to himself.
- You fool! In Scripture, a fool is not someone with low intelligence, but someone who dishonors and disobeys God (Psalm 14:1–5).
- your life will be required of you: The man believed his soul was secure, but God was not pleased with him.

Luke 12:22–34

After Jesus warns against greed (not being content), he teaches about living in dependence on God (12:13–21). The disciples of Jesus were to focus on God's kingdom and his purpose in this world rather than being obsessed with possessions.

Luke 12:24

Consider the ravens: Ravens were ceremonially unclean (Leviticus 11:15; Deuteronomy 14:14). But God cared even for them (Psalm 147:9).

Luke 12:25

add a single hour to his life (literally add a single cubit to his length): Worry cannot make life any longer.

Luke 12:27

King Solomon was one of the wealthiest kings in the world during his time (see 2 Chronicles 9:13–22).

Luke 12:30

the Gentiles: The Greek word ethnē can mean "the nations" or "the Gentiles." To a Jewish audience, it meant all who were not God's people.

Luke 12:31

seek His kingdom: Live God's way, follow his purpose, and obey him.

Luke 12:32

little flock: God is the shepherd of his people (Psalm 23; Jeremiah 13:17; Ezekiel 34; Zechariah 10:3). Israel's leaders were also known as shepherds. The prophets criticized them for harming or neglecting their people ("flock"; Ezekiel 34; Zechariah 10:3).

Luke 12:33

- Sell your possessions and give to the poor: This is not a command to sell everything a person owns, because other parts of the Bible assume that believers may own property. Instead, it means recognizing that everything we have belongs to God and should be used to serve him and his people (see Acts 2:44–45; 4:32–34). Believers are responsible for helping the poor, especially other believers (Galatians 6:10).
- treasure in heaven: See Luke 16:1–13 and Matthew 6:19–21. When God gives wealth, he also gives an opportunity to help people in need.

Luke 12:35

keep your lamps burning: This is a picture of being ready and staying watchful (Exodus 27:20–21; Leviticus 24:2; Psalm 18:28; Matthew 25:1–13).

Luke 12:35–48

Jesus compared his faithful followers to servants in a master's house. These servants were always ready for his return and did a good job managing the resources he left with them.

Luke 12:36

The master could return from the wedding banquet at any time of day or night. The followers of Jesus should always remain faithful and prepared for his return.

Luke 12:37

- he himself will come and wait on them: In Middle Eastern culture, the master would never serve his servants. Jesus changed the master's role by serving his disciples, offering himself for them, and providing for all their needs (see 22:24–27).
- he will dress himself to serve: In this culture, servants often tied up or adjusted their long robes before working so they could move freely. The picture here is surprising because the master takes the place of a servant and personally cares for his

guests. This shows the generosity and humility of the master.

Luke 12:40

the Son of Man will come: See "The Son of Man" Theme Note.

Luke 12:42

The faithful, sensible servant was a household manager. Wealthy homeowners appointed gifted and educated slaves as chief executive officers over their affairs.

Luke 12:44

in charge of all his possessions: In the Roman world, many servants were slaves and were legally considered the property of their masters. Even so, some slaves were given great responsibility. They could manage the household, oversee property, and act with the authority of the master.

Luke 12:46

- He will cut him to pieces: Harsh physical punishment like this was known in the ancient world. It is not clear whether Jesus was describing punishment in this life or final judgment.
- assign him a place with the unbelievers: This could mean treating him like an unbeliever in this life, or condemning him with unbelievers in the final judgment. The meaning depends on whether Jesus was speaking about discipline for an unfaithful believer or condemnation of an unbeliever. In either case, the warning is clear: an unfaithful servant will face severe judgment.

Luke 12:47–48

- Who knows ... who unknowingly: Sins committed in ignorance receive less punishment than deliberate sins (Numbers 15:22–26; Psalm 19:13; compare Luke 23:34).
- From everyone who has been given much: Believers will be held responsible for the knowledge and resources they have been given (James 3:1). A sin in ignorance is still a sin.

Luke 12:49

I have come to ignite a fire: The ministry of Jesus brought great change. It brought judgment on the wicked and purification for the righteous (see 3:16–17; 9:54; 17:29; Deuteronomy 4:24; Amos 5:6; Hebrews 12:29).

Luke 12:50

a baptism to undergo: The Scriptures often describe God's judgment as an overwhelming flood (Psalms 18:4; 42:7; 69:1–2; Isaiah 8:7–8; 30:27–28; Jonah 2:5).

Luke 12:51–53

No, I tell you, but division: The ministry of Jesus demands a decision for or against God that divides even family members.

Luke 12:53

Jesus quotes Micah 7:6, which was interpreted by the rabbis as the crisis and persecution that would lead to the Messiah's coming.

Luke 12:54

Clouds beginning to form in the west brought rain from the Mediterranean Sea.

Luke 12:55

The hot south wind blows into Israel from the Arabian Desert to the south and east (Job 37:17; Jeremiah 4:11).

Luke 12:58

on your way to the magistrate: This case involved an unpaid debt and could lead to prison for the debtor. The officer was either a court official or a prison guard. It was wise to settle matters with your accuser before reaching the court. In the same way, people should make things right with God before the final judgment.

Luke 13:1

the Galileans whose blood Pilate had mixed with their sacrifices: This specific event is not mentioned in other known sources. But Pilate was a harsh governor who violently put down unrest on several occasions (see Josephus, War 2.9.2–4; Antiquities 18.3.1–2).

Luke 13:1–4

Jesus was responding to a popular claim that bad things only happen to bad people. Sin has negative consequences, but not every bad thing is a result of sin. Jesus then clarified that all people are sinners who need to repent (13:3, 5; see Job 4:7; 8:4, 20; 22:5; see also Psalms 34:21; 75:10; Proverbs 3:33; 10:3, 6–7, 16, 24–25; John 9:2–3).

Luke 13:4

when the tower of Siloam collapsed: This incident is not mentioned anywhere else in Scripture or other known records. The pool of Siloam was a reservoir in

the southeastern part of Jerusalem. The tower may have been part of Jerusalem's southern wall.

Luke 13:6

a fig tree: People sometimes described Israel as a fig tree without fruit or a vineyard that God would judge (Isaiah 5:1–7; Micah 7:1–2; see Jeremiah 8:13; 24:1–10; Hosea 9:10).

Luke 13:6–9

The parable of the barren fig tree (a story about a tree that does not produce fruit) shows the ministry of Jesus to Israel. If the nation did not produce the fruit of repentance (turning away from sin), it would face judgment. The story does not give a final ending, which shows that Israel still had a chance to respond. Compare with Matthew 21:18–19 and the similar passage in Mark 11:12–14.

Luke 13:9

cut it down: A stump or fallen tree symbolized judgement or destruction (compare 3:9; see also Isaiah 6:13; 10:34; 11:1; Jeremiah 46:22; Daniel 4:23; Matthew 3:10; 7:19).

Luke 13:10

Jesus was teaching in one of the synagogues (see 4:14–30): Visiting Jewish rabbis (religious teachers with authority) often taught after reading the Law and the Prophets in the synagogue.

Luke 13:11

disabled by a spirit: See study note on 11:14.

Luke 13:14

not on the Sabbath: Jewish rabbis (religious teachers with authority) debated whether people should give medical help on the Sabbath day. They decided it was suitable only in extreme emergencies.

Luke 13:15–16

- You hypocrites! Hypocrites are people who pretend to be good or righteous, saying one thing but doing another. The religious leaders would care for their own animals on the Sabbath, but they would not help another person in need.

There is also a play on words in the text. The same word is used for "untie" (13:15) and "released" (13:16). The leaders would free their animals but not a daughter of Abraham, one of God's chosen people.

- whom Satan has kept bound: This means she was under the power of Satan. Jesus drove out demons and healed people, which showed the kingdom of God (God's rule) and the defeat of Satan (see 11:20).

Luke 13:17

Jesus gave a wise answer that made his enemies feel shame and fall silent. In Jewish society, honor was a very important value.

Luke 13:18–21

The parables of the mustard seed and the yeast reveal the nature of the kingdom of God. Like a mustard seed, it grows from a tiny size until it becomes large. Like yeast (leaven) in dough, it spreads through everything.

Luke 13:19

the birds of the air nested in its branches: The birds represent people who see the kingdom as a safe and secure place.

Luke 13:21

It is like the leaven: Leaven (or yeast) can represent evil (see 12:1; 1 Corinthians 5:6; Galatians 5:9). But here it shows the positive, spreading, and transforming power of the kingdom.

Luke 13:23

will only a few people be saved?: Some believed that only a small number would be saved. Others thought that all Jews would be saved because they were descendants of Abraham (see study note on 3:8).

Luke 13:25

- After the master of the house gets up and shuts the door: At a banquet or feast, the master locks the door after the guests with an invitation arrive.
- I do not know where you are from: In Scripture, knowing often means being chosen by God for a special relationship (Isaiah 63:16; Jeremiah 1:5; Amos 3:2). The people of Israel were God's chosen people. They came from Abraham's family line (where you are from), but those who failed to respond to the invitation did not have a relationship with God. The same can be said of all who fail to respond to the good news of the kingdom of God.

Luke 13:28

- The phrase weeping and gnashing of teeth shows rejection and suffering.
- Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob were the three main founding fathers (patriarchs) of Israel.

Luke 13:29

Although many Israelites, God's chosen people, have rejected the gospel, people from all over the world will accept God's offer of salvation and attend the future banquet of the Messiah (see 14:15; 17:20; Isaiah 2:2; 25:6–8; 51:4; 52:10; 55:5; 56:7; 59:19; Micah 4:1–2; Zechariah 2:13; Malachi 1:11).

Luke 13:32

- Go tell that fox: In the first century AD, Jews saw foxes as harmful and animals that had no worth.
- driving out demons and healing people: These actions showed that the kingdom of God was already present. His resurrection on the third day would later show that he truly brought in God's kingdom.

Luke 13:33

a prophet to perish: See "The Suffering Prophet" Theme Note.

Luke 13:34

as a hen gathers her chicks: Compare Deuteronomy 32:11; Ruth 2:12; Psalms 17:8; 36:7; 57:1; 61:4; 63:7; 91:4.

Luke 13:35

- Your house is left to you desolate: Jesus predicted the destruction of Jerusalem that took place in AD 70.
- Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord: This refers to Psalm 118:26. Psalm 118 was one of the psalms sung by people traveling to Jerusalem for the annual festivals. Here, Jesus referred to his second coming.

Luke 14:1

in the home of a leading Pharisee: In the Gospel of Luke, Jesus often eats with others.

Luke 14:2

a man with dropsy: Dropsy, medically known as edema, is an accumulation of fluid in tissues or a body cavity that causes swelling. It is usually a symptom of a more serious illness.

Luke 14:3

Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath or not?: The Jewish rabbis (religious teachers with authority) debated this question (see study note on 6:6–7).

Luke 14:5

Jesus pointed out the hypocrisy of the Pharisees. Hypocrisy means pretending to be righteous while acting differently. See also study note on 13:15–16.

Luke 14:7

the places of honor: Meals in the ancient world showed social status. A person's place at the table depended on that status. The food each guest received could also reflect status. These guests were trying to get the places of highest honor.

Luke 14:8

The response of Jesus comments on a teaching found in Proverbs 25:6–7. In that passage, wisdom warns people not to take places of honor for themselves. Instead, they should wait to be invited to a higher place. When Jesus gave his response, he applied this wisdom to his own time. He taught that people should not seek honor for themselves. Instead, they should be humble and allow God or others to honor them.

Luke 14:9

in humiliation: In first-century Jewish culture, honor was very important. This kind of humiliation would have been almost worse than death.

Luke 14:12–13

do not invite your friends: Jesus challenged the common use of banquets to show and increase social status in the community. A host would invite friends of similar status and a few people of higher status. Those honored guests were then expected to invite the host back, which could improve the host's reputation and position.

Jesus turned this social order upside down by telling his followers to invite people who had no status and could not repay them. In this way, God invites sinful people to share in his banquet of salvation.

Luke 14:14

the resurrection of the righteous: See Daniel 12:2.

Luke 14:15–24

This parable shows what was happening in the ministry of Jesus. The rich, powerful, and important people rejected his invitation to God's banquet of salvation, so they would be left out. Meanwhile, poor people and outcasts accepted the invitation (see also 1:52–53; 6:21, 25; 10:15; 18:14).

Luke 14:17

Come, for everything is now ready: The invitations had been sent earlier. The guests were called when the meal was ready.

Luke 14:18

- They all began to make excuses: All these excuses would have deeply offended the host, who had spent much time and money preparing this important social event. These guests had already accepted the invitation, and their excuses were weak. Clearly, they did not want to come to the banquet.
- I have bought a field, and I need to go see it: No one would buy a field without seeing it first.

Luke 14:19

oxen, and I am going to try them out: This is another weak excuse. No one would buy oxen without having seen them plow.

Luke 14:20

I have married a wife: Some people consider this to be a good excuse since the Old Testament excused men from military service during their first year of marriage (Deuteronomy 20:7; 24:5). But this feast was a local community event, not a distant war. Additionally, in an Israelite village, people would not have planned a marriage and a banquet at the same time, so there was no real conflict.

Luke 14:21

The poor, the crippled, the blind, and the lame were often treated as outsiders in Israel. Jesus reached out to them and helped them.

Luke 14:23

Go out to the highways and hedges: These people invited might refer to the Gentile, who later received the good news about Jesus and the kingdom of God (compare Acts 9:15; 13:46–48; 18:4–6; Romans 11:11–12).

Luke 14:25–35

large crowds were traveling with Jesus: Jesus was very popular, but he was about to teach that the cost of following him was also very high.

Luke 14:26

If anyone comes to Me and does not hate ... even his own life: Following Jesus requires complete dedication. For the Christian, love for family and one's own life must not compete with devotion to Christ.

Luke 14:27

carry his cross: This symbolizes rejecting personal desires. A criminal sentenced to crucifixion would carry the horizontal beam of the cross to the place where the authorities would kill them.

Luke 14:34

Salt ... if the salt loses its savor: Sodium chloride cannot actually lose its saltiness. Jesus might be speaking hypothetically (if salt were to lose), or he might be referring to a combination of minerals that included salt. The salt around the Dead Sea was a mixture of sodium chloride and other minerals. If the sodium chloride dissolved or was removed, the remaining material still looked like salt but no longer tasted salty.

Luke 14:35

It is fit neither for the soil nor for the manure pile: Salt had various uses in the ancient world, including flavoring (14:34), preserving, and weed-killing. The sludge left after removing the sodium chloride was useless.

Luke 15:1

People greatly disliked tax collectors because they worked for the hated Roman authorities. The tax collectors had a reputation for not being honest.

Luke 15:1–32

Chapter 15 contains three related parables of things lost and found:

- a sheep (15:1–7),
- a coin (15:8–10), and
- a son (15:11–32).

The loss of something loved causes deep sorrow, whereas finding it brings great joy. There is great rejoicing in heaven when lost sinners return to their heavenly Father.

Luke 15:2

In their self-righteous hard-heartedness, the Pharisees and teachers of religious law did not care about lost people. Jesus embodied the heart of God, who longs for his wayward children to return.

Luke 15:4

- A flock of a hundred sheep was of average size for a shepherd of modest means. God's people are often identified as the Lord's flock (Psalm 23; Isaiah 53:6; Jeremiah 13:17; Ezekiel 34; Zechariah 10:3).
- leave the ninety-nine: Other shepherds could watch the ninety-nine, so those left behind were not in

danger. The shepherd would do anything to find the one that was lost.

Luke 15:8

- Ten silver coins: These coins might have been part of the woman's dowry. A dowry was money or property given to a husband by the bride's family.
- light a lamp, sweep her house: Homes in Palestine were usually dimly lit and often had dirt or stone floors. Because of this, finding a small coin could be difficult.

Luke 15:11–32

Like the previous two parables (15:3–7, 8–10), the parable of the lost son demonstrates God's love for the lost and the joy God experiences when they return. It also reflects the ministry of Jesus. The father represents God, the younger son represents the tax collectors and sinners Jesus welcomed, and the older son represents the religious leaders.

Luke 15:12

give me my share of the estate: At this time, this shocking request would basically mean, "To me, you are dead." He could not say anything more insulting to his father.

Luke 15:13

he squandered his wealth in wild living: In Jewish culture, losing family property to Gentiles in a distant land was considered especially shameful. In some cases, it could even lead to exclusion from the community (see also Deuteronomy 21:18–21).

Luke 15:15

Pigs were ceremonially unclean animals (Leviticus 11:7; Deuteronomy 14:8). So this was the most shameful job a Jew could have.

Luke 15:20

- his father saw him: The father was watching the road, hoping his son would return.
- He ran to his son: Since running was not appropriate for the leader of the family, this expressed how happy the father was that his son came back.

Luke 15:21

The son delivered the speech he had practiced. Some early Greek manuscripts add Please take me on as a hired servant. The absence of this sentence in the majority of the manuscripts suggests his father interrupted him before he could finish what he wanted to say.

Luke 15:22

- The best robe belonged to the father. It affirmed the son's role as an heir and a beloved member of the household.
- Put a ring on his finger: A ring was a symbol of authority. Like the robe, it indicated his status as son and heir.

Luke 15:23

The father had been preparing a calf for a feast. He welcomed his son with the kind of honor shown to an important guest.

Luke 15:28

The older brother was angry that his father would forgive such a sinner when he, the faithful son, had worked hard to achieve his position. Like the religious leaders, he refused to rejoice when his brother was found.

Luke 15:30

this son of yours: He refused to acknowledge his own relationship to his brother.

Luke 15:31

you are always with me: The parable ends without telling us how the older brother responded. In the same way, the religious leaders still had a chance to respond to the offer of the kingdom.

Luke 16:1

There was a rich man whose manager: Wealthy landowners commonly put managers over their estates.

Luke 16:2

Turn in an account of your management: This financial statement was probably meant for the person who would replace the manager.

Luke 16:3

too ashamed to beg: The Jewish wisdom writer Sirach said, "It is better to die than to beg" (Sirach 40:28). This reflects how many Jews viewed begging.

Luke 16:5–7

The manager called in his master's debtors and reduced their debts. He made friends who would help him when he no longer had a job.

Luke 16:6

A hundred measures of olive oil ... fifty: The measure in Greek is a batos (from the Hebrew bath), a standard unit for measuring liquids. A hundred measures could have been about 3,000 liters (800 gallons), and fifty measures about 1,500 liters (400 gallons). The exact sizes are uncertain.

Luke 16:7

A hundred measures ... eighty: The Hebrew word for measures here is cor. This was the standard dry measure. A hundred measures could have been around 35,000 liters (9,300 gallons or 1,000 bushels) and eighty measures around 28,000 liters (7,400 gallons or 800 bushels). The exact size of the cor is uncertain.

Luke 16:8

- The ways of the world are the opposite of God's ways. The children of this world use all their resources to succeed or gain an advantage in this world. God's people do just the opposite (16:9).
- the sons of the light: These are God's people (see John 12:36; 1 Thessalonians 5:5).

Luke 16:8–9

Jesus seems to praise the manager for acting wisely, not for being dishonest. It likely means that believers should use their resources wisely as they prepare for eternity.

Luke 16:9

- Worldly wealth: This is a better translation than the traditional "mammon of unrighteousness" (KJV). Believers are to use their resources wisely for spiritual benefit.
- they will welcome you into eternal dwellings: This probably refers to the friends gained through faithful use of wealth. Just as the manager's friends gave him security, the people brought into God's kingdom will welcome believers into eternal homes.

Luke 16:13

No servant can serve two masters: Complete love and devotion can be given only to one master.

Luke 16:14

The Pharisees ... heard all of this and were scoffing: People often thought wealth was a reward from God, so the Pharisees rejected the warning Jesus spoke about money.

Luke 16:16

- John the Baptist was a transitional figure. He was the last of the Old Testament prophets and the messenger who announced the coming age of salvation (see 1:5–25, 57–80; 3:1–20; 7:18–35).
- everyone is forcing his way into it: The verb usually refers to force or violence and may describe people trying to force their way into or oppose the kingdom (see Matthew 11:12). More likely, however, it describes people urgently pressing forward to enter the kingdom.

Luke 16:17

- This does not mean the Law has lost its power. The new covenant fulfilled the Old Testament laws and prophets, but the Law remains (however, compare Acts 15:23–29).
- God will cause heaven and earth to pass away and replace them with a new heaven and earth at the end of the age (Revelation 21:1). But God's word lasts forever (Psalm 119:89, 160; Isaiah 40:8; 55:10–11).

Luke 16:18

- This example fits the context by showing that the authoritative words of Jesus interpreted and fulfilled the Old Testament law.
- Anyone who divorces his wife and marries another woman commits adultery: The Old Testament allowed divorce but did not approve of it (Deuteronomy 24:1–4). In the time of Jesus, Jewish teachers debated what counted as valid grounds for divorce. The school of Shammai taught that a man could divorce his wife only for sexual unfaithfulness. The school of Hillel allowed divorce for almost any reason.

Against this casual view of marriage, Jesus taught that divorcing a spouse and marrying another person was equal to committing adultery. In other passages (Matthew 5:32; 19:9), Jesus gave a clear exception for cases of unfaithfulness.

Luke 16:19

Purple was the color worn by royal people. Phoenician purple was an expensive dye made from mollusks.

Luke 16:19–31

This parable repeats the warning about the danger of riches (16:13–15). It also returns to the idea that when God's Kingdom comes, many situations will be reversed (changed to the opposite).

The rich, proud, and powerful will be brought low, while the poor, humble, and oppressed will be lifted up.

Luke 16:21

Even the dogs came and licked his sores: This is an image of misery and poverty. In Jewish culture, dogs were seen as unclean animals and scavengers (animals that eat what others leave behind).

Luke 16:22

carried by the angels to Abraham's side: The Greek suggests a banquet at which guests reclined around a low table (see John 13:23). Lazarus was taken to the messianic banquet in the kingdom of God (see Luke 14:1–24).

Luke 16:23

Hades: This can refer to either the place where all people go when they die, or where the wicked go after death, as in this context.

Luke 16:24

- send Lazarus: Ironically, the man was still treating Lazarus as a lowly servant.
- I am in agony in this fire: See Matthew 25:41; Revelation 20:10, 14–15.

Luke 16:26

nor can anyone cross from there to us: This verse gives the general principle that a person's state after death is permanent.

Luke 16:31

they will not be persuaded even if someone rises from the dead: Wicked people refuse to repent even when faced with overwhelming evidence of the truth.

Luke 17:1

- Woe!: This is a strong warning or expression of sorrow. In the Bible, it often introduces a message of judgment. See study notes on 6:24–26; 11:42–52.
- the one through whom they come: Leaders have more responsibility because they have to give an account for themselves and those they lead (see James 3:1).

Luke 17:2

A millstone is a large, round stone with a hole in its center. People used it to grind grain in a mill. A millstone could weigh hundreds of pounds.

Luke 17:4

Even if he sins against you seven times in a day: The number seven here does not mean an exact number, but rather "many times" (see Psalm 119:164). See Matthew 18:21–22.

Luke 17:6

- A mustard seed was a common example of something very small (see 13:19).
- you can say to this mulberry tree, 'Be uprooted': Black mulberry trees can live for hundreds of years and have wide and deep roots, making them very hard to pull out of the ground.
- it will obey you: This does not mean people should use faith to perform random miracles. God has unlimited power, and those who trust him will see him act according to his will.

Luke 17:7–10

In Greco-Roman culture, servants were expected to serve their masters faithfully. Faith (17:5–6) includes obeying Christ and submitting to his commands.

Luke 17:11

While Jesus was on his way to Jerusalem: see study note on 9:51–19:44.

Luke 17:11–19

This healing reveals the compassion and power of Jesus. In Luke, the blessings of salvation are joyfully received by many outside Israel.

Luke 17:12

They stood at a distance: See study note on 5:12. People with leprosy had to stay away from others and shout, "Unclean, unclean!" (Leviticus 13:45–46).

Luke 17:14

- "Go, show yourselves to the priests.": Leviticus 14:2–32 guides priests on how to determine what is leprosy and declare a leper ceremonially clean (see study notes on Luke 5:12, 14).
- as they were in their way: To leave without yet being healed required faith, which Jesus was testing (compare 2 Kings 5:9–14).

Luke 17:16

The one man who returned to thank Jesus was a Samaritan, a hated foreigner in the eyes of most Jews (see study note on 10:33).

Luke 17:19

your faith has made you well! (or your faith has saved you): The Greek verb can refer to either physical or spiritual healing. The physical healings of Jesus show the salvation that his kingdom brings.

Luke 17:20–21

- When the kingdom of God would come: Many Jews believed that the Messiah (Christ) would establish God's kingdom in Jerusalem. They expected him to defeat Israel's enemies and bring peace, prosperity, justice, and righteousness (see 3:15; compare Acts 1:6).

The Pharisees were likely questioning the claim that Jesus was the Messiah (God's chosen king). He was not defeating the Romans or setting up a visible kingdom on earth, as they expected. Jesus did not deny this future aspect of the kingdom (see Luke 21:27; Matthew 24:30–31). But he explained that the kingdom of God was being revealed through his ministry, though they were missing it.

- The kingdom of God will not come with observable signs: Jewish writings in the time of Jesus expected visible signs in the sky to announce the Messiah's kingdom. Jesus confirmed that such signs would appear (see Luke 17:24; 21:25; Acts 2:19–20). But the Pharisees were missing how God's kingdom was already being shown in the ministry of Jesus at that time (compare Luke 7:22).
- the kingdom of God is in your midst (or is within you, or is in your grasp): The kingdom of God was already being shown through the words and actions of Jesus. It is unlikely that Jesus would say, "the kingdom of God is in your midst," to those rejecting his message.

Luke 17:20–37

This is the first of two teachings in the Gospel of Luke about the coming of the kingdom of God and the return of the Son of Man (a title Jesus uses for himself). The second teaching appears later in chapter 21.

Luke 17:22

you will long to see one of the days of the Son of Man: This may refer to his time on earth with his disciples or to the time of his second coming.

Luke 17:23–24

- People will tell you, 'Look, there He is!: False messiahs have appeared throughout history. In the first century, many people claimed to be God's agents of salvation (see Acts 5:36–37; 21:38). Jesus warned his disciples not to follow these false leaders.
- just as lightning flashes: Lightning lights up the whole sky and is visible to everyone in the area. Similarly, when Jesus suddenly returns, it will be evident to everyone.

Luke 17:25

suffer many things: Jesus would soon die by crucifixion (see study note on 9:22). Crucifixion was a form of execution used by the Romans. The victim was nailed or tied to a wooden cross and left to die.

Luke 17:26–29

in the days of Noah ... in the days of Lot: See Genesis 6–9 for Noah and Genesis 18:16–19:29 for Lot. Both stories describe God's severe judgment against human evil.

Luke 17:32–33

Lot's wife turned into a pillar of salt when she looked longingly back at Sodom (Genesis 19:26). She is an example of those who hold on to their old way of life instead of trusting God.

Luke 17:34–35

one will be taken and the other left: The comparisons to God's judgment in the great flood and against Sodom (17:26–29), and the reference to vultures and a dead body (17:37), suggest that this separation happens at the final judgment. This is when the wicked are taken away in judgment and the righteous are left (see Malachi 3:18; Matthew 25:32).

Luke 17:37

so these signs indicate that the end is near: This clause, which does not appear explicitly in the Greek, explains the significance of the cryptic saying about the vulture.

Luke 18:1–8

The parable of the persistent widow follows naturally from the teaching of Jesus about coming troubles (17:20–37). Believers can face trials and persevere through persistent prayer.

Luke 18:2

a judge who neither feared God nor respected men: The two most important attributes for a good judge are regard for justice (fear of God), and compassion for people (see 2 Chronicles 19:6–7). This judge had neither.

Luke 18:3

- a widow: God cares for widows, orphans, and foreigners. These were the most vulnerable people in ancient society. He has promised to judge those who treat them badly (Exodus 22:22; Deuteronomy 10:18; 24:17; 27:19; Psalm 68:5; Isaiah 1:23; 10:2; Jeremiah 22:3; Ezekiel 22:7; Amos 5:10–13; Zechariah 7:10; Malachi 3:5).
- Give me justice: The woman was right in this dispute. She was not asking for special treatment.

Luke 18:5

keeps pestering me: This vivid Greek expression literally means "striking the eye" or "giving me a black eye," like a boxer hitting an opponent. It describes someone being worn down by constant persistence.

Luke 18:7

Will not God bring about justice: If persistence resulted in justice from this unjust judge, how much more will God, who loves both people and justice, answer our prayers.

Luke 18:8

- When the Son of Man returns: This refers back to the vision in Daniel 7:13–14.
- will He find faith on earth?: The question is whether believers will remain faithful to God during the difficulties that happen before the second coming of the Son of Man (see Matthew 24:10–12; 2 Thessalonians 2:3; 1 Timothy 4:1).

Luke 18:9–14

The topic of prayer (18:1–8) leads into this parable about the right attitude for approaching God.

Luke 18:10

a tax collector: See study note on 3:12.

Luke 18:12

I fast twice a week and pay tithes of all that I acquire: Fasting (not eating food) and tithing (giving a tenth of one's income) were signs of religious devotion in Judaism. The law required fasting only once a year (Leviticus 16:29–31). But many devout Jews in the time of Jesus fasted twice a week (see also Luke 5:33; 11:41–42).

Luke 18:13

he beat his breast: This action showed deep sorrow and repentance (turning away from sin).

Luke 18:14

- Jesus concluded that only the tax collector went home justified before God. This would have surprised the people listening to Jesus, who considered Pharisees righteous and tax collectors evil.
- everyone who exalts himself will be humbled: See 1:52–53; 6:21, 25; 10:15; 14:11; 16:19–31.

Luke 18:15–17

- This incident illustrates 18:14.
- they rebuked those who brought them: In this cultural setting, children had little social importance (see study note on 9:48). Because of this, the disciples saw them as interrupting the important ministry of Jesus.

Luke 18:17

receive the kingdom of God like a little child: Entrance into the kingdom of God requires childlike faith and dependence on God.

Luke 18:18

- The man was probably a religious leader, not a political ruler.
- what must I do to inherit eternal life?: This question was commonly discussed by the rabbis in the time of Jesus (see 10:27).

Luke 18:18–30

The story of the rich religious leader warns against trusting in riches rather than pledging complete allegiance to God.

Luke 18:19

Why do you call Me good?: The man called Jesus good as a compliment, but only God is truly good. Jesus challenged the man's understanding of goodness. True goodness requires moral perfection.

Luke 18:20

You know the commandments: Jesus refers to the fifth through ninth of the Ten Commandments (Exodus 20:12–16; Deuteronomy 5:16–20). These command-

ments are about relationships between human beings.

Luke 18:21

All these I have kept: The man's claim to have kept all the commandments shows that he misunderstood the nature of true goodness.

Luke 18:22

The man's love for his wealth showed he did not fully obey God. He did not love God or others as God requires (10:25–28). Loving wealth is a form of worshiping false gods (idolatry) (Ephesians 5:5; Colossians 3:5).

Luke 18:24–25

- How hard it is for the rich to enter the kingdom of God!: Scripture sometimes describes riches or wealth as a blessing from God (2 Chronicles 1:11–12; Psalms 112:3; 128:2; Proverbs 8:18; Isaiah 61:6). But many passages warn against trusting in riches instead of God (Psalm 62:10; Proverbs 11:28; Jeremiah 9:23–24; 49:4–5).
- the eye of a needle: See study note on Mark 10:25. This is not only difficult, but impossible. No one can be saved while trusting in riches. Salvation comes only by dependence on God (Luke 18:27).

Luke 18:27

The point of this whole event is that salvation is impossible by human effort, but possible by the grace of God.

Luke 18:28–30

we have left all we had to follow You: In contrast to the rich ruler, Peter and the other disciples had given up everything to follow Jesus. Jesus affirmed that they would receive back far more than they had given up.

Luke 18:30

receive many times more in this age: Their reward would not necessarily be physical, but they would enjoy the blessings that come from spiritual wholeness and a right relationship with God.

Luke 18:31

The death of Jesus fulfilled all the predictions of the Old Testament prophets. It was God's plan (Luke 24:25–26, 46; Acts 2:23; 3:18; 4:28).

The main prophecy about the suffering Messiah is in Isaiah 52:13–53:12. Luke also refers to several Old Testament prophecies, including:

- Psalm 2 in Acts 4:25–26,
- Psalm 16 in Acts 2:25–28,
- Psalm 118:22 in Luke 20:17, and
- Isaiah 50:4–9 in Luke 18:32–33.

Luke 18:31–34

This was the last time Jesus predicted his suffering and death before he entered Jerusalem for his final week of ministry (see also 9:22, 44–45; 17:25).

Luke 18:32–33

will be mocked ... will flog Him: See Isaiah 50:6.

Luke 18:34

The disciples did not understand any of these things: The disciples did not understand that the death of Jesus would bring salvation until after he rose from the dead (see 9:45; 24:13–34).

Luke 18:35

Jericho was located in an oasis in the Judean wilderness, 30 kilometers (18 miles) northeast of Jerusalem. At 250 meters (820 feet) below sea level, it is the world's lowest city and one of the oldest.

Luke 18:35–43

This story shows again how Jesus cares for the poor and people who had less social status in Israel. It also reminds us that Jesus is the Son of David, the Christ (18:38), shortly before he enters Jerusalem as king (19:28–44).

Luke 18:38

Son of David is a title for the Christ (the Messiah, God's chosen king). The Christ is a descendant of David who will rule on David's throne forever (see 1:32–33; 2 Samuel 7:11–16; Isaiah 9:6–7; 11:1–5; Jeremiah 23:5–6; 33:15–16; Ezekiel 37:24–25).

Luke 19:1–10

The story of Zacchaeus is a fitting high point to the ministry of Jesus among those treated badly in Israel while he traveled to Jerusalem (9:51–19:44). Many see the final verse of this episode as the main theme of Luke's Gospel (19:10).

Luke 19:2

A chief tax collector paid the Roman government for the right to collect taxes in a certain region. He then supervised other tax collectors and received money from the taxes they collected. This system allowed Zacchaeus to become very rich. As a result, chief tax collectors were hated even more than the tax collectors under them (see study note on 3:12).

Luke 19:4

climbed a sycamore-fig tree: This action was very undignified for a man with the power and wealth of Zacchaeus. It shows that he truly wanted to see and know Jesus.

Luke 19:5

Zacchaeus ... I must stay at your house today: Jesus knew Zacchaeus's name and invited himself to his home. This showed that the authority of Jesus is from God and that this meeting was part of God's plan.

Luke 19:7

The guest of a sinful man: People also criticized Jesus for spending time with sinners, as they did when he was with Levi (5:27–32; see study note on 5:30).

Luke 19:8

I will repay it fourfold: The usual payment for causing financial loss was to repay the amount taken plus twenty percent (Leviticus 5:16; Numbers 5:7). However, the penalty for stealing an animal was four or five times its value (Exodus 22:1). Zacchaeus apparently viewed the money he had gained through dishonesty as theft and promised to repay it fully.

Luke 19:9

this man too is a son of Abraham: Zacchaeus was a son of Abraham by birth because he was a Jew. Now he also showed the same kind of faith that Abraham had (see Romans 4:11–12).

Luke 19:10

to seek and to save the lost: The Lord Jesus is like a shepherd who looks for lost sheep (see Psalm 23:1; Isaiah 53:6; Jeremiah 13:17; Ezekiel 34; Zechariah 10:3; 13:7).

Luke 19:11–27

This parable has two main purposes:

1. To teach stewardship. This means managing gifts and resources well while the man of noble birth (Jesus) is away (compare Matthew 25:14–30).
2. To correct the belief that the kingdom of God would start immediately when Jesus entered Jerusalem. Most Jews in the time of Jesus expected that when the Messiah (the Christ) came, God's kingdom would be established physically on earth, with Jerusalem at its center (see Isaiah 2:2–4; 35:1–10; 65:17–25; Jeremiah 30–31; Ezekiel 37, 40–48; Micah 4:1–5).

Luke 19:12

A man of noble birth went to a distant country to lay claim to his kingship: This account shows Judea's status as a client kingdom of the Roman Empire. After a king's death, those claiming the right to be king would travel to Rome to seek support. Similarly, Jesus would first leave for heaven to receive his royal authority and later return to rule God's people and judge those who oppose him (see 19:14, 27).

Luke 19:14

his subjects hated him and sent a delegation: This happened to Archelaus, the son of Herod the Great, who violently put down protests after the death of his father. In response, the Jews sent representatives to plead against his kingship before the Roman emperor.

Luke 19:17

you shall have authority over ten cities: Because of the servant's faithfulness, the king gave him a major position in his kingdom. Similarly, those who are faithful to Jesus in this life will receive greater responsibility here and great rewards in heaven.

Luke 19:23

deposit my money in the bank (Literally put the money on the table): This means to give it to those lending money who will loan it out for interest.

Luke 19:26

will be given more: Those who are trustworthy with a small amount will receive more (compare 8:18).

Luke 19:27

- And these enemies of mine: Those who do not accept Jesus as king will encounter his judgment. This part of the parable was directed against the religious leaders.

- bring them here and slay them: A new king would often kill his opponents (see 1 Kings 2:13–46; compare Psalm 2).

Luke 19:28–40

Jesus entered Jerusalem in triumph. This fulfilled Zechariah 9:9–10 and symbolically announced that he was the Messiah, the King of Israel.

Luke 19:29

- Bethany was on the eastern slope of the Mount of Olives, over three kilometers (two miles) east of Jerusalem. It was the home of Lazarus and his sisters, Mary and Martha (John 11:1, 18; 12:1; see Luke 10:38).

The exact location of Bethphage is unknown, but it was likely near Bethany on the road from Jericho.

- the Mount of Olives: The Mount of Olives overlooks Jerusalem from the east and has significance at the return of Christ (see Acts 1:11; Zechariah 14:4).

Luke 19:30

You will see a young donkey: It is unclear whether Jesus had arranged for the donkey ahead of time or whether he used divine knowledge. Either way, his entry into Jerusalem was a symbolic act. Jesus rode on a humble donkey instead of a warhorse to show that he was the Christ who came to bring peace and reconciliation (Zechariah 9:9–10).

Luke 19:31

The Lord needs it: Subjects of a king were expected to make resources available for his use (see 1 Samuel 8:16). The donkey's colt was pure and suitable for a king because no one had ever ridden it.

Luke 19:36

The crowds spread their cloaks to show respect and honor to this royal figure (see 2 Kings 9:13).

Luke 19:38

- Blessed is the King who comes in the name of the Lord! See Psalms 118:26; 148:1. Psalm 118 was one of the songs sung by travelers going to Jerusalem for the festivals (Psalms 113–118).
- Jesus brought peace in heaven and glory in the highest. He makes peace with God and humans, but peace on earth is still to come (compare Luke 2:14; see 12:51–53; 19:41–44).

Luke 19:40

Compare Isaiah 55:12, in which nature is said to rejoice at the coming of God's salvation, and Habakkuk 2:11, in which the stones of the walls cry out against Babylon.

Luke 19:42

now it is hidden from your eyes: Israel's rejection of Jesus had serious consequences. In this context, the decision was final and could not be reversed.

Luke 19:43–44

- Jesus foretold that the Romans would surround and destroy Jerusalem in AD 70. The Jewish historian Josephus describes the terrible suffering of the people in Jerusalem during the Roman siege (War 5.1.1–7.1.1).
- will not leave one stone on another: This expression describes complete destruction.

Luke 19:45

People who came to worship at the temple bought animals there for sacrifices. Jesus also drove out the money changers who exchanged ordinary money for the special coins used to pay the temple tax (Matthew 21:12; Mark 11:15; see Exodus 30:13–16; Nehemiah 10:32–33).

These services were necessary, but Jesus opposed the dishonest business practices that turned the temple into a place for personal profit instead of worship. The temple was meant to display God's glory to all nations, but it had become corrupt.

Luke 19:45–48

After entering Jerusalem as the Christ, Jesus performed an action that showed he was the Christ (see Malachi 3:1). He began to drive out from the temple those who exchanged money and merchants selling animals for offerings. This action was meant to restore true worship in the temple. It also symbolized the judgment that Jesus had just announced against Israel (19:41–44).

Luke 19:47

- The clearing of the temple increased opposition to Jesus and helped lead to his death on the cross (see study note on Mark 11:12–25).
- In Galilee, the main opponents of Jesus were the Pharisees and teachers of religious law. In Jerusalem, the leading priests also opposed him because they controlled the temple. The actions of

Jesus against the buying and selling in the temple threatened their authority.

Luke 20:1

the chief priests and scribes, together with the elders: These were the most influential Jewish leaders in Jerusalem. They united against Jesus because he threatened their authority.

Luke 20:1–47

In this series of controversies between Jesus and the religious leaders of Jerusalem, they repeatedly questioned and challenged him, and he repeatedly outmatched them with his spiritual wisdom, insight, and authority.

Luke 20:2

by what authority are You doing these things: Since these groups were the recognized Jewish authorities in Jerusalem, they wanted to know how Jesus could claim authority to enter Jerusalem as a king and drive the merchants from the temple.

Luke 20:4–6

The question Jesus asked trapped the religious leaders (see 20:5–6) because either answer would accuse them.

Luke 20:6

The people will stone us: Stoning was a capital punishment where people threw rocks at the offender until he or she died. Stoning was the punishment for:

- blasphemy (speaking against God; Leviticus 24:14–15).=,
- idolatry (worshiping false gods; Leviticus 20:2; Deuteronomy 13:10), and
- other acts of opposition against God.

The people might have considered rejecting a true prophet as blasphemy, which deserved the penalty of stoning.

Luke 20:7–8

The Jewish authorities refused to answer the question Jesus asked, so Jesus had no obligation to answer their question. Both their question and their refusal were guided by self-interest rather than integrity.

Luke 20:9

rented it out to some tenants: This was a common practice in first-century Palestine, especially in Galilee. Many poor farmers would rent land from wealthy owners so they could grow crops.

Luke 20:9–19

This story adapts Isaiah's Song of the Vineyard (Isaiah 5:1–7) to describe the rejection of Jesus by Israel's leaders. In Isaiah's story, the vineyard owner represents God, and the vineyard represents Israel, which failed to produce good fruit and would be judged.

Jesus added new characters to the story. The tenant farmers represent Israel's unrighteous leaders, the servants represent the Old Testament prophets who were repeatedly rejected, and the son represents Jesus. God would judge Israel's leaders for rejecting and killing his Son.

Luke 20:10

the tenants beat the servant: God's prophets were often mistreated and opposed by the people of Israel (1 Kings 19:10, 14; 2 Chronicles 24:21; 36:16; Nehemiah 9:26; Jeremiah 2:30; 26:20–24; 37:15).

Luke 20:13

my beloved son: The Messiah was predicted to have a unique father-son relationship with God (see 2 Samuel 7:14; Psalms 2:7; 89:26–29).

Luke 20:14

Let us kill him, and the inheritance will be ours: They believed that killing the heir would give them power over the estate. They foolishly failed to realize that the owner was still alive and would demand justice. Similarly, the religious leaders thought that they could keep their authority over the people of Israel by killing Jesus.

Luke 20:17

The stone ... cornerstone: Jesus quoted Psalm 118:22 to predict that he would be rejected and later restored to honor. The cornerstone was the most important stone in a building because it helped support and align the walls. Jesus was rejected by the builders, meaning the religious leaders, but he would become the foundation of a new building, the church.

Luke 20:18

Jesus expanded the stone metaphor (20:17) with references to Isaiah 8:14–15 and Daniel 2:34, 44–45. Although Israel rejected him, Jesus became the foundation for the new people of God. He began the reign of a kingdom that would last forever.

Luke 20:19

realized that Jesus had spoken this parable against them: The story provoked the religious leaders to act it out by arresting and killing Jesus.

Luke 20:20–26

The religious leaders asked this question to trap Jesus, but he answered in a way that avoided their trap.

Luke 20:21

we know that You speak and teach correctly: These dishonest words of praise were meant to trick Jesus (see Psalms 5:9; 12:2–3; 78:36; Proverbs 26:28; 28:23; 29:5; Ezekiel 12:24).

Luke 20:22

Is it lawful for us to pay taxes to Caesar or not?: If Jesus said yes, he would make the people angry, because they hated the burden of Roman taxation. If he said no, he would be accused of rebellion against the Roman authorities.

Luke 20:24

a denarius: This Roman coin had the image and inscription of the emperor Tiberius Caesar (see 3:1) stamped on it.

Luke 20:25

Give to Caesar what is Caesar's: Jesus gave a clever answer. There are two ways to understand this statement. On the surface, he said that the coin belonged to Caesar and should be given to him. But his Jewish listeners also understood that, in the end, nothing truly belongs to Caesar, because everything belongs to God.

Luke 20:27

the Sadducees, who say there is no resurrection: See "The Sadducees" Profile.

Luke 20:28

Moses wrote for us: A dead man's brother would marry the widow to produce children who would maintain the dead man's name and property (Deuteronomy 25:5–6; see also Genesis 38:8–10; Ruth 4:1–12).

Luke 20:29–33

Well, suppose there were seven brothers: A similar story of a woman married to seven husbands appears in the Old Testament Apocrypha (Tobit 3:7–17; 6:10–8:18).

Luke 20:33

in the resurrection, whose wife will she be?: The Sadducees told this made-up story to show that the idea of resurrection (rising from the dead) did not make sense. They wanted people to think that belief in resurrection was foolish.

They likely used this same argument many times. It was a common attack that the Sadducees used when they debated the Pharisees.

Luke 20:35

will neither marry nor be given in marriage: Jesus taught that marriage belongs to this present life on earth. It is not part of life after the resurrection (when the dead rise to life again).

Luke 20:36

because they are like the angels: Angels are not married, and they are immortal. The Bible never teaches that people become angels (compare Hebrews 1:5–2:18), but that we will be like them.

Luke 20:37

- After answering the Sadducees' question about marriage, Jesus turned to the larger question of the resurrection (rising from the dead).
- Even Moses demonstrates that: Jesus used the books of Moses to show that the resurrection is true. These books (Genesis, Exodus, Leviticus, Numbers, and Deuteronomy) were the only Scripture the Sadducees recognized as authoritative.
- the God of Abraham ... Jacob: God called himself the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob long after these patriarchs had died. Since he was still their God, they must have had a continuing existence after death.

Luke 20:39

Teacher, You have spoken well!: Most teachers of religious law were Pharisees, so they agreed with Jesus on the resurrection and were pleased that he refuted the Sadducees.

Luke 20:40

The wise answers of Jesus confused his opponents. They could not defeat him in argument.

They had tried to trap him with difficult questions. Instead, his replies exposed their motives and showed his wisdom.

As a result, their plans to trap him failed.

Luke 20:41

The Old Testament predicted that the Messiah would be a descendant of King David (see study note on 18:38).

Luke 20:41–44

After Jesus silenced his opponents, he began to challenge the religious leaders and their understanding of the Messiah.

Luke 20:42–43

Jesus quotes Psalm 110:1. By quoting this verse, Jesus shows that the Messiah (God's chosen leader) is more than a descendant of David. The Messiah is also David's Lord.

Luke 20:44

Jesus asked why King David called his son (meaning his descendant) his Lord. The implied answer was that the Christ was more than a human king from David's family line. He is Lord of all (see 2:11; Acts 10:36).

Psalm 110:1 became an important passage for the apostles. It confirms that Jesus is the Son of God (see Mark 14:62; Acts 2:34; 7:56; Romans 8:34; 1 Corinthians 15:25; Ephesians 1:20; Colossians 3:1; Hebrews 1:3, 13; 8:1; 10:12–13; 1 Peter 3:22; Revelation 3:21).

Luke 20:46–47

- Jesus continued confronting his opponents by warning people about the hypocrisy and exploitation practiced by the teachers of the law. These leaders sought honor and respect for themselves while taking advantage of vulnerable people.
- the greetings in the marketplaces: See study note on 11:43.
- the places of honor at banquets: See study notes on 5:30; 14:7.

Luke 20:47

They defraud widows: This might mean taking advantage of widows' property that they should have protected. It could also mean forcing widows to give more money than they could afford.

Widows were the most vulnerable members of society. God had special concern for them. He would judge those who took advantage of them (Exodus 22:22; Deuteronomy 10:18; 27:19).

Luke 21:1

The Greek term for treasury likely refers to boxes with trumpet-shaped openings for collecting offerings.

Luke 21:1–4

Jesus set the sacrificial offering of the poor widow in contrast to the greed and hypocrisy of the rich people, including the teachers of religious law (20:45–47).

Luke 21:2

two small copper coins: These coins (Greek lepta) were worth about 1/64 of a denarius. A denarius was the wage a laborer would receive for one day of work.

Luke 21:4

The size of the gift matters less than the attitude of the person who gives it.

Luke 21:5

- adorned with beautiful stones: Herod the Great rebuilt and restored the temple in Jerusalem, producing one of the great structures of the ancient world. According to the historian Josephus, the massive white stones reflected the sun with such brilliance that from a distance the temple looked like snow-covered mountains (War 5.5.6).
- The memorial decorations were probably funded by offerings given by worshipers to fulfill vows.

Luke 21:5–38

When Jesus predicted the destruction of the temple in Jerusalem, his disciples asked when it would happen and what signs would accompany it (21:6,7). Jesus responded by describing the events surrounding the destruction of the temple and the return of the Son of Man (21:8–36). This sermon is known as the Olivet Discourse because the Mount of Olives was where Jesus taught (see Matthew 24:3; Mark 13:3).

Luke 21:6

not one stone will be left on another: See study note on 19:43–44.

Luke 21:8

claiming, 'I am He,': See study note on Mark 13:5–6.

Luke 21:8–11

Jesus spoke about events that many people misunderstand as signs of the end of the age. These events include false messiahs (people who claim to be God's chosen one), wars, earthquakes, famines (times when there is not enough food), and severe persecution (violent suffering because of faith).

However, Jesus made it clear that these events do not mean the end will happen right away. The end will not come immediately after these things.

Luke 21:11

- Destructive events like these are often associated with:
- the judgment of God (1 Samuel 14:15; Psalm 18:7–8; Isaiah 2:19, 21; 5:25; 13:13; 24:18; 29:5–6; Jeremiah 14:12; 21:6–7; Ezekiel 14:21; Amos 1:1) and
- the end of the age (Isaiah 24:18; 29:5–6; Ezekiel 38:19; Joel 2:10; Haggai 2:6, 21; Zechariah 14:4; compare Revelation 6:12; 8:5; 11:13, 19; 16:18).
- great signs from heaven: See study note on 21:25.

Luke 21:12

deliver you to the synagogues: Jesus and his early followers were Jewish. The first conflicts were with Jews who did not accept Jesus as the Christ. The followers of Jesus were sometimes tried in the synagogues before a Jewish court (compare 2 Corinthians 11:24).

Luke 21:12–19

they will seize you and persecute you: Jesus described the persecution his followers would experience (see also Matthew 10:17–22; Mark 13:9). Jewish writings from the time of Jesus also described a period of great hardship before God's final salvation would arrive.

Luke 21:15

I will give you speech and wisdom: God often assured his prophets that he would give them the words to say (Exodus 4:12, 15; Deuteronomy 18:18; Isaiah 50:4; 51:16; Jeremiah 1:9). The disciples of Jesus were to prepare themselves to speak clearly as witnesses (see Colossians 4:5–6; 2 Timothy 2:21; 1 Peter 3:15). They knew that the Holy Spirit would help them respond as powerfully as Jesus had done (Luke 20:20–44).

Luke 21:16

Families in Jewish and Gentile communities have often been divided as some members follow Jesus and some reject him.

Luke 21:18–19

not even a hair of your head will perish: This expression means complete protection (1 Samuel 14:45; 2 Samuel 14:11; 1 Kings 1:52; Daniel 3:27). Here, it refers to the disciples' souls, because some would be killed because of their faith (Luke 21:16).

Luke 21:20–24

Jesus was describing the siege and destruction of Jerusalem that would take place in AD 70.

Luke 21:21

those in the city get out: Because of this prophecy, Christians in Judea fled to the town of Pella in Decapolis before the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70 (Eusebius, Church History 3.5).

Luke 21:22

these are the days of vengeance: The destruction of Jerusalem was part of God's judgment for Israel's rejection of the Messiah.

Luke 21:24

until the times of the Gentiles are fulfilled: Daniel predicted that a series of Gentile empires (kingdoms ruled by non-Jews) would come before God's kingdom (Daniel 2:44; 7:27).

Luke 21:25

The prophets predicted that signs in the sky would come before God's judgment at the end of time (Isaiah 13:9–10; 34:4; Jeremiah 4:23, 28; Ezekiel 32:7–8; Joel 2:10, 30–31; compare Revelation 6:13–14; 8:10; 9:1; 12:1, 3; 15:1).

Luke 21:31

All these things refer to the events described in 21:25–30.

Luke 21:32

this generation will not pass away: This saying is difficult to understand. Jesus seems to have predicted that he would come again before the first generation of his disciples died out. There are three main interpretations:

1. the reference is to the destruction of Jerusalem in AD 70 when Jesus "came" in judgment against Israel;
2. this generation refers to a future generation alive when these signs start to happen;
3. the term generation could mean "people," referring to the Jewish people, who will not disappear before Christ returns.

Luke 21:33

Heaven and earth will pass away: See study note on 16:17.

Luke 21:34

The main theme of this teaching is, "Watch out!" Believers must always stay alert and be ready for Christ's return.

Luke 21:36

to stand before: This means to "pass the test" and stand approved before Jesus Christ at his second coming.

Luke 22:1

The Passover meal was held on the 15th of Nisan (March~April) in the Jewish calendar and was immediately followed by the seven-day Feast of Unleavened Bread (Exodus 12:1–20; 23:15; 34:18; Deuteronomy 16:1–8). This feast is sometimes also called Passover.

Luke 22:1–6

The religious leaders who had been plotting against Jesus (see 19:47) found their opportunity when Judas Iscariot approached them with an offer to betray Jesus.

Luke 22:3

Satan entered Judas Iscariot: See John 13:2; Acts 5:3. Earlier, Satan had tempted Jesus and had been waiting for this opportunity (Luke 4:2, 13).

Luke 22:4

temple officers: These were leaders within the temple's own security force. The temple had its own police force to keep order and protect the sacred area.

Luke 22:5

Judas wanted the money. Judas wanted the money. John says that he was a thief and used to steal from the money bag of the disciples (John 12:6).

Luke 22:6

in the absence of a crowd: They waited until the crowds were not present. They did this because Jesus was very popular with the people.

The leaders were afraid of how the crowd might react if they arrested him in public.

Luke 22:7

The Passover lamb was killed at twilight (the time between sunset and darkness). The Passover meal was then eaten that same evening (see Exodus 12:6–8).

Luke 22:7–30

Jesus celebrated the traditional Jewish Passover but transformed it with reference to his own sacrificial death as the Passover lamb. He also prepared his disciples for his coming death and the leadership role they would assume over his church.

Luke 22:8

Go and make preparations for us to eat the Passover: The lamb was roasted and eaten with bitter herbs and unleavened bread at the Passover meal (Exodus 12:8; Numbers 9:11–12; Deuteronomy 16:3). The bitter herbs represented the bitterness of the Israelites' slavery in Egypt, and the unleavened bread reminded them of their hurried departure from Egypt.

Luke 22:10

a man carrying a jug of water: This was unusual because women usually carried the water.

Luke 22:11–12

The text does not say whether Jesus knew about the room because of his divine nature or if he had made arrangements for this room ahead of time (see also 19:30–34).

Luke 22:14

Jesus reclined at the table: The Jewish people adopted the Greek custom of reclining on couches next to tables at banquets (see study note on John 13:23).

Luke 22:15

Jesus ate the Passover meal with his disciples and followed the ritual order of the Passover celebration (see study note on Matthew 26:26–29).

Luke 22:16

until it is fulfilled in the kingdom of God: This celebration pointed forward to the messianic banquet, the great feast in God's kingdom (see 14:1–24). The death of Jesus as the true Passover lamb established the kingdom of God (1 Corinthians 5:7). During his earthly ministry, Jesus began God's saving rule, and God's kingdom will be fully completed when he returns.

Luke 22:17

After taking the cup: The traditional Passover meal included four cups of wine:

- one cup was shared at the beginning blessing,
- another after the Passover explanation,
- another after the meal, and

- the last after a final psalm.

The cup Jesus took here was probably the first cup used in the Passover ceremony.

Luke 22:19–20

- Using the bread and the cup as symbols of his body and blood, Jesus established the communion meal that his disciples were to continue in remembrance of his death.
- This is My body, given for you: The unleavened bread of the Passover represented the death of Jesus as the Passover lamb. He would allow his blood to pour out "for the forgiveness of sins" (Matthew 26:28; compare 1 Corinthians 11:24–25).

Luke 22:20

In the Old Testament, God confirmed his covenants with the blood of a sacrifice (Genesis 15:9–10; Exodus 24:8). The death of Jesus established the new covenant that God had promised to his people (Jeremiah 31:31–34).

Luke 22:21–22

it has been determined: Wicked men betrayed and killed Jesus, but this took place as part of God's purposeful plan to bring salvation (see Acts 2:23).

Luke 22:22

woe to that man who betrays Him: Judas suffered guilt, judgment, and a terrible death for betraying Jesus (Matthew 27:5; Acts 1:18).

Luke 22:24

which of them should be considered the greatest: See also Mark 9:33–37 and 10:35–45.

Luke 22:25

benefactors: This translates a Greek word that refers to the practice of rulers bestowing gifts and favors on their subjects to gain loyalty and honor. Jesus contrasted this worldly style of leadership (military power, coercion, and bribery) with his own servant leadership in giving himself for others.

Luke 22:27

I am among you as one who serves: Jesus defined true leadership as serving others. This means meeting the needs of others and empowering them to be all that God has called them to be (see Mark 10:45). This idea was surprising in a culture where status and power were important.

Luke 22:29–30

you may eat and drink at My table: See "The Messianic Banquet" Theme Note.

Luke 22:30

judging the twelve tribes of Israel: This could be a figurative reference to the apostles' leadership in the church. Or it could refer to their special role in the future, when God's kingdom will be fully established on earth (compare Ephesians 2:20; Revelation 3:21; 20:4).

Luke 22:31

- Satan: See 4:2; 10:18; 11:15. Satan is the accuser of God's people (see Job 1:7; 2:2). He would test Simon Peter and the rest of the apostles.
- has asked to sift: People would sift wheat to separate grain from the parts you do not eat using a device called a sieve. This image represents extreme testing (see Isaiah 30:28; Amos 9:9).
- all of you: The Greek here is plural. It refers to all the disciples. Jesus predicted Peter's denial and the difficult experiences of the other disciples.

Luke 22:32

when you have turned back: The you here is singular and refers to Peter's restoration after he denied Jesus.

Luke 22:33

See Acts 4:3; 5:18; 12:1–9, where Peter suffered trials and was repeatedly jailed. Church tradition relates that Peter was crucified in Rome, but his declaration of loyalty here was premature.

Luke 22:34

On Thursday evening, Jesus said that Peter would deny him before the rooster crows tomorrow morning (literally a rooster will not crow today until). This does not contradict Mark's account: "this very night, before the rooster crows twice" (Mark 14:30). The Gospels of Luke and Matthew provide a more general account, and in Jewish tradition, the next day begins at sunset.

Luke 22:36

- the one with a purse should take it, and likewise a bag: The apostles had traveled without supplies and relied on the support of other people for their missions to Israel's villages (9:3; 10:3–4). In the dangerous days to come, they would have to plan more carefully. Jesus prepared his disciples for his suffering and death, and also for the establishing of the church and the worldwide proclamation of the good news.

- a sword: Jesus was probably not telling his followers to use weapons or fight. Instead, he was speaking figuratively, warning them to prepare for a time of violent conflict and suffering.

Luke 22:38

That is enough: The disciples' two swords were probably not enough to defend the whole group, and Jesus elsewhere rejected violence (22:49–51; Matthew 26:52). Jesus might have meant that two swords were sufficient to fulfill Isaiah 53:12. Or perhaps he meant something like, "Enough of this foolish talk, you do not understand me."

Luke 22:39

Mount of Olives: See study note on 19:29. This was the location of the garden of Gethsemane (see Matthew 26:36; Mark 14:32).

Luke 22:42

take this cup from Me: A cup is a metaphor for experiencing either judgment or blessing (see, for example, Psalms 23:5; 75:8; 116:13; Isaiah 51:17). Jesus felt all the emotions of his humanity, including fear and anxiety.

Luke 22:43

an angel from heaven: Angels often help and encourage human beings (see Hebrews 1:14; compare 1 Kings 19:5–8; Psalm 91:11–12; Daniel 3:28; 10:16–19).

Luke 22:44

His sweat became like drops of blood falling to the ground: The text does not say that Jesus sweated blood, as people often think. It says that his sweat fell to the ground like blood. This probably means that, in his agony, he was sweating very heavily.

Luke 22:45–46

Jesus prayed in great distress, while the disciples failed to remain alert against temptation.

Luke 22:47

A kiss was a common way for friends to greet each other. Judas's kiss made his betrayal even more clear.

Luke 22:51

He touched the man's ear and healed him: The Gospel of John tells us that the man's name was Malchus and that Peter was the one who cut off his ear (John 18:10). Peter probably believed that he was beginning the final battle and that God's heavenly army was about to appear and destroy the Romans. When Jesus refused to fight, the frightened disciples ran away (Matthew 26:56; Mark 14:50).

Luke 22:52

outlaw: The Greek word here typically means "thief." However, the Romans used this term for violent revolutionaries who opposed Roman authority (such as Barabbas, 23:18–19). To many patriotic Jews, these revolutionaries were seen as freedom fighters. To the Romans, they were violent criminals.

Luke 22:54

the house the high priest: This home could have belonged to Caiaphas, the current high priest, or Annas, his father-in-law and a previous high priest (see study note on 3:2; John 18:12–14).

Luke 22:59

for he too is a Galilean: Peter's way of speaking made it clear that he was from Galilee (compare Judges 12:5–6).

Luke 22:61

the Lord turned and looked at Peter: At that time, Jesus was inside the house, where the leaders were questioning him. He may have looked through a window or an open entryway (a covered space at the entrance of a house).

When their eyes met, the rooster crowed. Then Peter remembered what Jesus had said earlier, that Peter would deny him (22:34).

Luke 22:63

began to mock Him and beat Him: See 18:32; Isaiah 50:6; 53:3–5.

Luke 22:64

Prophesy! Who hit You?: Jesus had a reputation as a prophet (4:24; 7:16, 39; 13:33; 24:19), so the soldiers mocked this claim.

Luke 22:66

- At daybreak: It was Friday morning (see study note on 22:34).
- the council of the elders ... met together: The Jewish high council (the Sanhedrin) was originally made up of the Jerusalem nobility, both civil leaders and priests, with the high priest as its leader. In the time of Jesus, the Sadducees still led the Sanhedrin (Acts

5:17). But leading Pharisees also held important positions on the council (Acts 23:7).

Luke 22:67–68

If I tell you, you will not believe: Jesus pointed out the hypocrisy in their question. They had already decided that he was not the Christ (the Messiah, God's chosen king), so answering them would not change their minds.

Luke 22:69

Jesus referred to Psalm 110:1 (compare Luke 20:42–43). Although the Romans would crucify him, God would vindicate Jesus through his resurrection. God would exalt Jesus to his right hand (see Acts 2:33–36; compare Daniel 7:13–14). Furthermore, Jesus would be seated in the place of power as Judge. He would soon sit in judgment over those who were trying him.

Luke 22:70

- The council members clearly understood what Jesus meant in 22:69. They expected the Christ to be the Son of God and have a unique father-son relationship with God (see study notes on 1:32–33; 4:41; compare 2 Samuel 7:14; Psalms 2:7; 89:26). The Sanhedrin accused Jesus of claiming to be the Christ (compare study notes on Mark 14:62, 63–64).
- You say that I am: This was a qualified affirmation, meaning that Jesus partly agreed with their statement. He probably meant, "What you say is true, but you do not understand what 'Christ' means." The council understood this as a confirmation (Luke 22:71).

Luke 22:71

Why do we need any more testimony?: The high council believed that when Jesus claimed to be the Christ and the Son of God, he was blaspheming (speaking against God). They thought this was proof of his guilt.

Luke 23:1

The Jewish council did not have the authority to carry out capital punishment under Roman rule (John 18:31). So they took Jesus to the Roman governor, Pontius Pilate. Pilate was in Jerusalem to keep order during the Passover festival, when large crowds could easily lead to unrest.

Luke 23:2

The religious charges against Jesus were now replaced by political ones in order to gain a Roman conviction. Pilate was only interested in what concerned Rome. The Jewish charge of blasphemy would not be sufficient, so the council had to show that Jesus was a danger to Rome. They accused Jesus of inciting insurrection against Roman taxation and claiming to be a king. All but the last charge were false.

Luke 23:3

You have said so: This is the same indirect answer that Jesus gave to the high council (22:70). Jesus accepted the title King of the Jews, but he understood it differently from Pilate.

Luke 23:4

I find no basis for a charge against this man: Jesus did not appear to be a political threat to Pilate.

Luke 23:5

He stirs up the people: This accusation was also false, but the religious leaders knew that Pilate feared civil unrest and revolt against Rome.

Luke 23:6–7

Pilate realized that Jesus was from Galilee and was under the authority of Herod Antipas. This gave Pilate a way to avoid the situation without condemning an innocent man or upsetting the religious leaders.

Luke 23:8

he was greatly pleased: He was curious about Jesus and his power to do miracles and teach, just as he had been curious about John the Baptist (9:7, 9; Mark 6:20).

Luke 23:9

He gave no answer: See Isaiah 53:7.

Luke 23:12

they had been enemies: There was a history of conflict between Herod Antipas and Pilate. Herod and three of his brothers had earlier accused Pilate before Tiberius Caesar. This happened when Pilate placed gold shields with pagan symbols in Jerusalem, and Tiberius ordered him to remove them.

Pilate also ruled Judea, a region that Herod Antipas's father, Herod the Great, had once ruled. Antipas hoped that he might one day rule this area himself.

Luke 23:14–15

Pilate and Herod repeatedly declared Jesus innocent (23:4, 22). Jesus was the righteous and innocent servant who suffered for the Lord (see also 23:41, 47; Isaiah 53:11).

Luke 23:16–18

I will punish Him: The Greek verb can mean "instruct," "punish," or "discipline." It refers to a mild whipping for minor offenses. This was different from the severe flogging Romans gave before crucifixion (see Matthew 27:26; Mark 15:15).

Luke 23:19

Palestine was a center of rebellion in the years leading up to the Jewish revolt against Rome in AD 66–74. The Jewish historian Josephus describes several first-century (see also Acts 5:36–37).

Luke 23:24

Pilate sentenced that their demand be met: Pilate was a practical but harsh leader. He thought it was better to allow injustice than to upset the religious leaders and crowds. He wanted to protect his political career (see John 19:12 and corresponding study note).

Luke 23:26

- Simon may have been a Jewish traveler visiting Jerusalem for Passover.
- they put the cross on him: Prisoners bound for crucifixion were normally forced to carry the crossbeam to the place of execution. It was fastened to the upright beam at the crucifixion site.

Luke 23:28

Jesus warned about the terrible things that would happen to Jerusalem during its siege and destruction in AD 70.

Luke 23:29

Blessed are the barren women: In that culture, not having children was usually considered a great shame (see study note on 1:7). But during this terrible disaster, women without children would be considered fortunate because they would not have to watch their children suffer and die from hunger.

Luke 23:30

'they will say to the mountains, "Fall on us!"': This refers to a time when people would prefer death over the terrible suffering they would face. Jesus warned that Jerusalem would experience such terrible pain and destruction that people would beg for mountains to fall on them to end their suffering quickly.

Luke 23:31

If the Romans crucified an innocent man while conditions were still calm and stable (while the tree is green), what worse things would happen when rebellion spread through the land (when it is dry)? Jesus used the picture of green wood and dry wood to contrast a peaceful time with a time ready for destruction. During the siege of Jerusalem (AD 66–70), the Romans crucified thousands of Jews outside the city.

Luke 23:33

- The Skull: The Greek name is kranion, and the Aramaic name is Golgotha (Matthew 27:33; Mark 15:22). The exact location is unknown, but people traditionally associate it with the Church of the Holy Sepulchre. Another suggested location is Gordon's Calvary, a rock formation near the Garden Tomb, though scholars consider this less likely.
- They crucified him there: People who were crucified were often tied to the cross or nailed through the wrists and ankles to speed up death. In this case, the bodies needed to be buried before sunset because the Sabbath was about to begin.

Luke 23:34

by casting lots (see John 19:23–24): The prisoner's possessions were treated as spoils of war and divided among the soldiers.

Luke 23:35

The people stood watching, and the rulers sneered at Him (see Psalm 22:7–8): Psalm 22 describes David, a righteous sufferer, crying out to God for help. Jesus, a descendant of David, was the ultimate righteous sufferer and fulfilled the words of Psalm 22.

Luke 23:36

sour wine: This was a popular drink of the lower classes, especially among soldiers (compare Psalm 69:21).

Luke 23:38

The sign confirmed that Jesus was crucified on the charge of claiming to be the King of the Jews (compare John 19:19–22).

Luke 23:42

remember me when You come into Your kingdom!: The criminal was perhaps thinking of the resurrection at the end of time, when Jesus would be raised up and vindicated by God.

Luke 23:43

- Jesus corrected the man by assuring him that today he would be vindicated in God's presence (see also 2:11; 4:21; 5:26; 19:9).
- Paradise: This word comes from a Persian word meaning "garden." It was used in Jewish literature for the garden of Eden and also for heaven, the place of eternal peace and joy for God's people (see 2 Corinthians 12:4; Revelation 2:7; compare Luke 16:22–23; 2 Corinthians 5:8).

Luke 23:44

Darkness symbolizes sorrow as well as God's judgment (Psalm 23:4; Isaiah 8:22; 9:1–2).

Luke 23:45

the veil of the temple: One curtain separated the temple courtyard from the Holy Place, and another separated the Holy Place from the Most Holy Place. Luke does not say which was torn down the middle, but it was probably the latter. The death of Jesus put an end to the sacrificial system of the temple and opened a new and permanent way into the presence of God (see Hebrews 10:19–20).

Luke 23:46

Father, into Your hands I commit My Spirit (see Psalm 31:5): Psalm 31 is another psalm about a righteous sufferer (a person who suffers but remains faithful to God; see study note on Luke 23:35).

Luke 23:47

righteous (compare Mark 15:39): Compare Luke 23:14–15. The innocent and righteous servant of the Lord died as a sacrifice for the sins of his people (Isaiah 53:11).

Luke 23:48

they returned home beating their breasts: This was a sign of sorrow and mourning.

Luke 23:50–51

- Not all the religious leaders opposed Jesus. Joseph had disagreed with the decision of the council.
- The exact location of Arimathea in Judea is unknown. It may have been Ramathaim, or Ramah, about 32 kilometers (20 miles) northwest of Jerusalem.

Luke 23:52

He went to Pilate to ask for the body of Jesus: The Romans used crucifixion as a public warning against revolt, so they did not generally allow a victim to be buried. Instead, they left the body exposed or rotting on the cross. An exception was made in this case, probably because Pilate knew that Jesus was innocent and because of Joseph's position of honor on the Jewish high council.

Luke 23:53

The new tomb had probably been purchased by Joseph as a family tomb.

Luke 23:54

- Preparation Day: This happened late on Friday afternoon. The Greek text does not specifically mention Friday. It refers to the day Jews prepare for the Sabbath day ceremonies during Passover week. The Sabbath day begins on Friday evening.
- As the Sabbath was about to begin, they had to bury the body quickly. The Jews could not work during the Sabbath, which began at sunset.

Luke 23:55–56

The women took special note of the tomb's location because they would return with spices and ointments to anoint his body. The spices were to mask the stench of a rotting corpse. A body would be placed on a stone bench in the side of the tomb until the flesh decomposed. The bones would then be collected and placed in a small ossuary, or bone box, and placed on a shelf in the tomb. In this way, a tomb could be used for many family members over an extended period of time.

Luke 24:1

On the first day of the week: The early church worshiped on the first day of the week (Sunday) instead of the seventh (Saturday, the Sabbath) because Jesus rose on a Sunday morning (compare Acts 20:7; Revelation 1:10).

Luke 24:1–12

Women were the first to find the tomb empty and to hear the announcement of the resurrection. This is strong evidence for the historicity of the resurrection accounts. In first-century Judaism, women were not regarded as reliable witnesses, so the church would never have created stories in which women discovered the empty tomb.

Luke 24:2

The stone was probably a large round stone that was rolled down a track to cover the tomb's entrance.

Luke 24:4

suddenly two men ... stood beside them: Angels often appear as young men in the Bible (Genesis 18:2; 19:1, 10; Joshua 5:13; Judges 13:6–11; Hebrews 13:2). Radiant apparel (bright, shining clothes) is a symbol of purity and holiness (Daniel 10:5–6; Acts 1:10; Revelation 4:4; 19:14).

Luke 24:5–7

Jesus had told his followers many times that he would rise from the dead (see 9:22, 44; 17:25; 18:31–34). The resurrection of Jesus is a key belief of the Christian faith (see 1 Corinthians 15:3–7, 12–57).

Luke 24:7

Jesus rose on the third day, counting Friday as the first day and Sunday as the third.

Luke 24:9

the Eleven: These were the Twelve disciples minus Judas. Judas Iscariot had betrayed Jesus and was no longer with them.

Luke 24:10

Luke 8:2–3 mentions Mary Magdalene and Joanna. Mary the mother of James is not the mother of James, the son of Zebedee (see Matthew 27:56). But she might be the mother of James, the son of Alphaeus (Luke 6:15).

Luke 24:12

Peter ... ran to the tomb: John went with him (John 20:2–9).

Luke 24:13

two of them: Jesus had many disciples in addition to the Twelve (see 10:1, 17). Nothing else is known of Cleopas or the other disciple, who might have been his wife (24:18). They were probably returning from celebrating the Passover feast in Jerusalem.

Luke 24:13–34

Luke alone records this resurrection appearance. Jesus corrected the disciples' misunderstanding by showing from the Scriptures that the Christ had to suffer. Then he opened their eyes to understand that he had risen from the dead.

Luke 24:16

were kept from recognizing Him: The Greek text uses a passive construction here. This is called a "divine passive" (a way of speaking that shows God is acting, even when God is not named). So here, even though the sentence does not name God as the one acting, the meaning is that God is the one who prevented them from recognizing Jesus. God chose not to let them see who he was until the moment he revealed himself, when Jesus broke bread with them (24:30–31; compare 2 Kings 6:17).

Luke 24:18

Are You the only visitor to Jerusalem who does not know the things: The Romans carried out crucifixions at busy public crossroads to make an example of the victims and warn others not to rebel. For these disciples, it was hard to imagine that a visitor in Jerusalem for Passover (a major Jewish festival) would not have heard about the crucifixion of Jesus.

Luke 24:19

Jesus is often portrayed as a prophet in Luke's Gospel (see 7:16; compare with the description of Moses in Acts 7:22).

Luke 24:21

we were hoping He was the One who would redeem Israel: This refers to the Messiah. The crucifixion had ended their hopes.

Luke 24:22

some of our women astounded us: See 24:10–11.

Luke 24:25–26

The prophets wrote that the Christ (the Messiah, God's chosen king) would have to suffer. The crucifixion did not show that Jesus was not the Christ. Instead, it confirmed that he is the Christ, because Scripture had already said that the Christ would suffer and die. Jesus corrected the two disciples because they did not understand from Scripture that this had to happen (see Isaiah 50:4–9; 52:13–53:12; Psalms 2, 16, 22, 118; compare Luke 18:32; 20:17; 23:37; Acts 2:25–28; 4:25–26).

Luke 24:27

all the Scriptures: This means all of the Old Testament. The Scriptures point forward to the coming of Jesus the Messiah and the salvation that he would bring.

Luke 24:29

they pleaded with Him, "Stay with us": In Middle Eastern culture, hospitality (kindness to guests) required people to offer food and a place to stay, even to a stranger (Genesis 18:3; 19:2; Judges 19:5–9).

Luke 24:30

- He was reclining at the table with them: The meal is a symbol of the messianic banquet (the future feast when God's chosen king gathers his people) and of the salvation that God is bringing about (Isaiah 25:6–8; Luke 14:1–24).
- and broke it, and gave it to them: This action recalls the feeding of the 5,000 (9:16) and the institution of the Lord's Supper (22:19).

Luke 24:31

- Their eyes were opened: This is another example of the "divine passive" (a way of speaking that shows God is acting, even when he is not named; see study note on 24:16). God opened their eyes when Jesus broke the bread. This means they were finally able to recognize Jesus.
- and He disappeared from their sight: In his resurrected and transformed body, Jesus showed abilities he had not shown before the resurrection (see 24:36; 1 Corinthians 15:20–23, 35–57).

Luke 24:34

Simon: The Gospels do not describe this appearance to Simon Peter, but Paul also confirms it in 1 Corinthians 15:5.

Luke 24:39

a spirit does not have flesh and bones, as you see I have: After rising from the dead, Jesus was not a spirit without a body. He had a real body that could never die again or decay. Believers will receive similar bodies at the final resurrection (1 Corinthians 15:35–57).

Luke 24:44

in the Law of Moses, the Prophets, and the Psalms: Jesus referred to the three sections of the Hebrew Scriptures: the Law, the Prophets, and the Writings. The entire Old Testament points to God's salvation through Christ.

Luke 24:46

The Christ will suffer and rise from the dead: See study note on 24:25–26.

Luke 24:47

repentance and forgiveness of sins will be proclaimed to all nations: See Isaiah 42:6; 49:6; Joel 2:28–32; Amos 9:11–12; Acts 2:17–21; 13:47; 15:16–18.

Luke 24:48

The primary role of the apostles in the book of Acts was to be witnesses to the fulfillment of Scripture in the life, death, and resurrection of Jesus (see Acts 1:8).

Luke 24:49

I am sending the promise of My Father: The Old Testament prophesied that God would pour out his Holy Spirit on all people (Isaiah 32:15; Jeremiah 31:33; Ezekiel 36:26–27; Joel 2:28–32). This prophecy came true on the day of Pentecost (Acts 2:14–21).

Luke 24:50

Bethany: See study note on 19:29. See also Acts 1:11–12; Zechariah 14:4.

Luke 24:50–53

Luke also tells about the ascension of Jesus (his return to heaven) in Acts 1:1–11. For Luke, this event showed that God had:

- vindicated Jesus (proved that he was right),
- exalted him (lifted him to the highest place), and
- seated him at his right hand as Messiah (God's chosen king) and Lord (the one with full authority; Acts 2:24–36).

From this place of glory and authority in heaven, Jesus leads and guides his church.

Luke 24:51

Compare 2 Kings 2:11. The ascension of Jesus marked his exaltation to a position of authority over all creation (see Acts 2:32–36; 5:31; Ephesians 1:19–23; Philippians 2:9–11; Hebrews 1:13).

Luke 24:53

the temple: This was a place for worship and sacrifice. The apostles continued in their Jewish manner of worship because their goal was not to create a new religion but to announce the fulfillment of Scripture's promises of salvation through Jesus the Messiah.